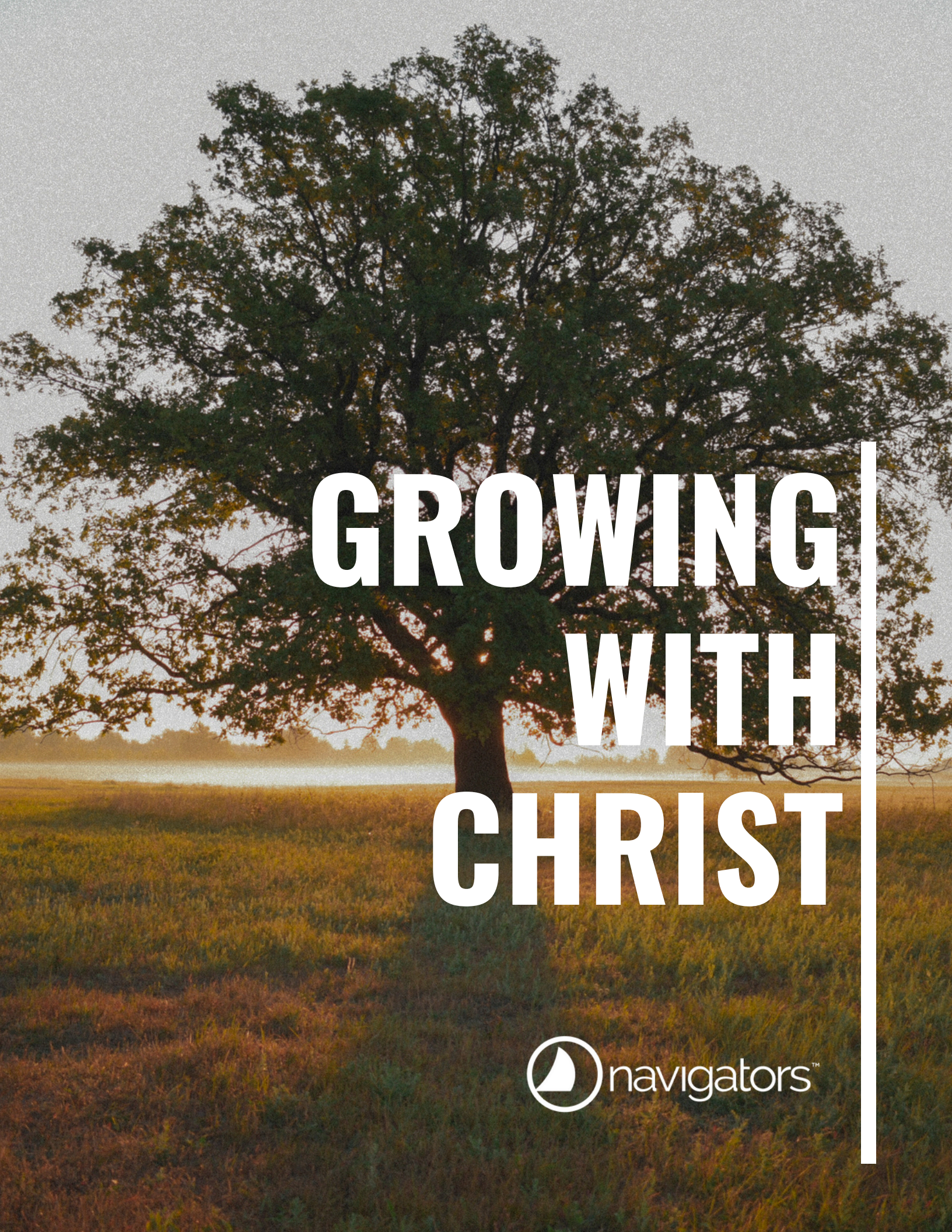
GROWING
WITH
CHRIST
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HOW TO GUIDE: USING THIS BINDER

This binder is a collection of resources to help you create disciple makers! This book is divided into 4 sections (Evangelize; Establish; Equip; Empower), each meant to help differentiate tools which may be helpful at different points in someone's walk with the Lord and disciple making journey.

Each tool is meant to only cover one small piece of the disciple making process. To learn from the model of Paul in 1 Thessalonians 2:8,

"...we loved you so much, we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well."

The template on the next page helps provide a plan for how to structure your meeting with a new disciple of Christ. It is helpful before each meeting to think through and record some thoughts under each section.

LIFE

A discipleship relationship where there is no authenticity quickly becomes robotic, leading the disciple to feel like a project rather than a person. Use this space to think through some questions that will help you enter into their life, and they into yours.

WORD

A discipleship relationship that does not center on the Word of God is simply a friendship. This is the space in the discipleship meeting to use this discipleship binder! Review the tool together and make any notes here. Before you meet together, consider: Why is this tool important for the person you are discipling? What do you want them to take away from your time together? What questions can you ask to engage their head (knowledge), heart (emotions), and hands (actions)? Would it be more helpful based on our context to share this tool from memory, or simply read through it together?

MISSION

We are all engaged in the Great Commission to "make disciples of all nations." Where does God have each of you right now? Who around you might He be wanting you to minister, witness to, or share God's love with? Consider your family, neighborhood, workplace, church family, friends, etc.

PRAYER

How can you be praying for each other and those around you this week? Write down any important prayer requests or verses you want to remember.

A QR code is provided at the top of the next page linking to a blank copy of this discipleship plan for you to use each meeting.

Lastly, remember this book is simply a collection of resources! If a book was all that was needed to make disciple makers, people like you would be unnecessary and the world would already be reached! God wants to use each of our lives and stories to raise up disciple makers who will go on to make disciples who make disciples. This binder is meant to help focus your time and help what you pass on to someone else be reproducible to the next generation of disciple makers!

God wants to use YOU to raise up disciple makers!

DISCIPLESHIP PLAN

LIFE	WORD	MISSION	PRAYER

List 2-4 questions you think would be helpful to ask to get to know them better:
(Think: family, highlights from the week, things they're learning about the Lord, challenges...)

-
-
-
-

Is there anything you need to follow up on from last week?

LIFE	WORD	MISSION	PRAYER

Read through the discipleship tool / passage you what to share. What is your objective in sharing this plan?

What application can they make from this plan for this next week?
Think S.A.M. (Specific, Attainable, Measurable)

LIFE	WORD	MISSION	PRAYER

Who is someone you and they can move toward this week?

How?

LIFE	WORD	MISSION	PRAYER

Prayer Requests:

EVANGELIZE

Resources for those who don't know Jesus yet or have not made Him Lord of their life

navigators™

Evangelize

THE THREE CIRCLES

Have you ever had anyone share the Gospel with you? Follow along below in the Three Circles illustration to make sense of and find healing from the brokenness we all experience.

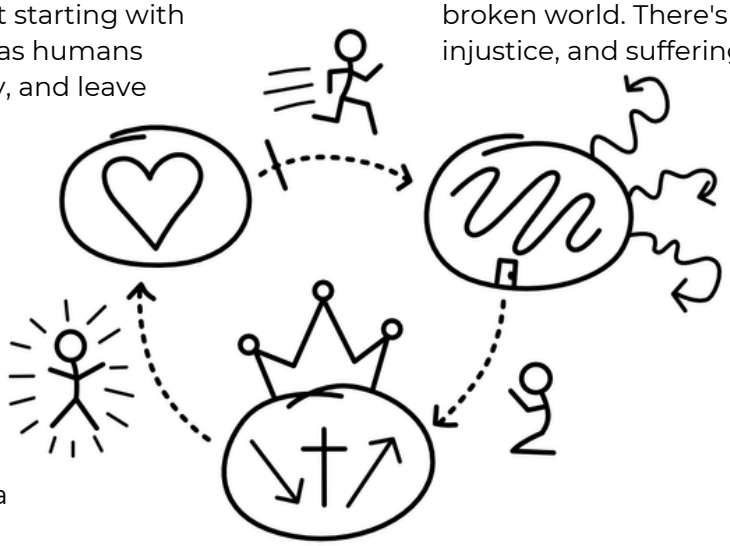
Scan the QR code to watch a video on how to share the Three Circles Illustration:

Perfect Creation 2

The world was perfect when God created it. There was no death, disease, injustice or suffering. But starting with the very first people, we as humans chose to go our own way, and leave God's perfect design. That's called sin. And sin led to the world's brokenness.

Broken World 1

If you turn on the television or look at your social media feed, it's very clear we live in a broken world. There's a lot of death, disease, injustice, and suffering.



Failed Escape 3

It is not pleasant to live in a broken world, so we try to get out. Some through climbing the ladder of success, others by doing good things, being religious or going to church. Some by drowning out the brokenness with drugs or a relationship. But like bungee cords, they keep snapping us back into our broken world.

Whole Redemption 4

But God loved us so much that He provided a way out of this broken-ness through His Son, Jesus. Jesus came down into our world, allowing Himself to be killed on a cross, taking on our sin. Three days later He rose from the dead, and declared that if anyone would turn from their ways, surrender to Him, and believe He died and rose again, they would be forgiven. They would also be made new and be able to experience God's perfect design for their life.

Questions 5

Where are you? Are you still in brokenness or have you placed your faith in Jesus, trusting Him for His perfect design for your life? What is keeping you from trusting Jesus as Lord?

Evangelize

WHO SITS ON THE THRONE?

Galatians 2:20 says *"For I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live but Christ in me. And the life I now live in the flesh, I live by faith in the son of God who loved me and gave himself for me."*

What are some observations about this verse?
Most would say "being crucified" is not good news. How do you think this would be good news?
Or to put it another way: If you were the master of your own island, how would it be good news to be conquered?

Consider three scenarios: (Write in the aspects of someone's life for each circle, i.e. academics, finances, relationships, etc. They should look the same in each scenario.)
(1) Self on the throne [Non-Christian]
How does it feel if one rules their own life? Consider who this person turns to when they need help, how they protect themselves, and concerns they might have.

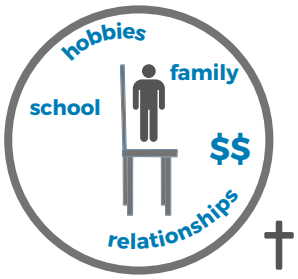
(2) Self on the throne; Jesus assisting with life [Cultural Christian]
What does it feel like to have Jesus assisting in someone's life? What would be indicators of a life like this? What would it take to "lose" favor in this situation? What feelings would come from this type of situation? Would it look any different than the first situation?

(3) Jesus sits on the throne; self inside of life [Contagious Christian]
What does it feel like to have someone who is good and powerful be in charge of someone's life? What is appealing about this? What is challenging?

How would it feel to have someone conquer your private island if they would rule the island better than you?

Non-Christian

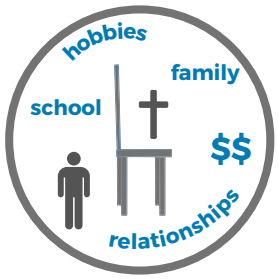
Self-Directed Life



Self is on the throne.
Christ is outside the life.
Interests are directed by self, often resulting in **anxiety and frustration.**

Contagious Christian

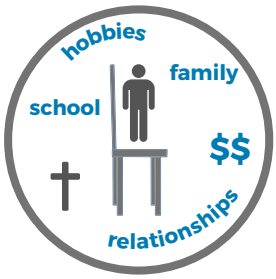
Christ-Directed Life



Life is Christ-centered
Self has been dethroned
Interests are still present but point back to Christ, leading to **hope, joy and peace**.

Cultural Christian

Self-Directed Life

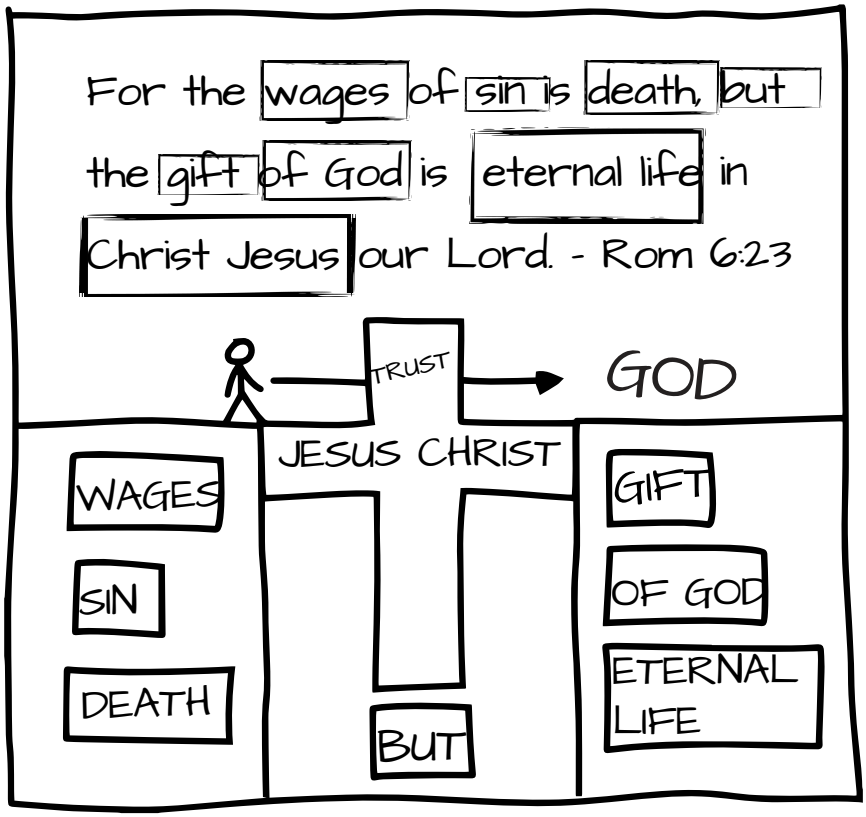


Self is on the throne.
Christ is dethroned.
Interests reveal a loss of love for God, His plans, and His ways; anxiety remains yet **legalism** reigns.

Questions to Consider:

Which picture most accurately displays your life? Why do you think that?
Which picture displays what you desire your life to look like? Why?
What action will you take to move towards the picture you desire?

Evangelize



The One Verse Bridge is a simple, interactive way to share Christ's love conversationally and visually. As you are in a conversation with a friend, you can illustrate Romans 6:23 on a napkin or piece of paper to explain God's relationship with people.

ONE VERSE BRIDGE

Circle WAGES and ask, "How would you feel if your boss refused to pay you the wages that were due to you?" Of course, your friend would want justice, the wages he had worked for. Deep down, we all know that it is only right that we get what we deserve.

Draw a circle around SIN, asking your friend what he thinks when he hears this word. You might explain that sin is more an attitude than an action. It can be either actively fighting God or as simple as excluding Him from our lives. Now draw two opposing cliffs with a gap in between.

Circle DEATH and ask what thoughts come to mind. Explain that death in the Bible always means some kind of separation—in its most basic sense, separation from life. Because God is the author of life, a spiritual death simply means separation from Him.

While circling the word BUT mention that it is important because it means that a sharp contrast in ideas is coming. What we have just looked at is the bad news; what comes next is the good news.

Draw a circle around GIFT. Ask, "If wages are what a person earns, then what is a gift?" Though every gift is free for the person receiving it, someone still has to purchase it.

Circle OF GOD and explain that the gift you are talking about is free. It is from God Himself. It's so special that no one else can give it. Ask, "How do you feel when someone gives you a special gift?"

Circle ETERNAL LIFE next, and then ask, "How would you define these words?" Contrast one side of the cliff, death, with the other side, eternal life. Ask, "What is the opposite of separation from God?"

Write JESUS CHRIST so it creates a bridge between the two cliffs. Help your friend to consider that just as every gift has a unique giver, only Jesus Christ can give the gift of eternal life.

Write TRUST over the bridge. Explain that a true friend is a friend you can trust; Jesus is offering to be a true friend to him. All he has to do is admit that he is responsible for his sin— either of fighting against God or excluding Him from his life. Trusting Jesus means believing that He has power to forgive us for rejecting God and that He will wash us clean from all that we have done wrong in life.

Now, ask your friend if he wants to start a relationship with God that will last forever. If he says "Yes," invite him to pray a short prayer in his own words, asking Jesus to forgive him and make him new. Close by reminding him that this simple illustration shows what God is like: Someone who really cares about people—especially him. Invite him to read all about it in the Bible.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. **To download a copy visit navlink.org/one-verse-evangelism**
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Evangelize

HOW MIGHT HOPE COME FROM KNOWING JESUS?

GOSPEL APPOINTMENT

"I AM THE MASTER OF MY FATE, I AND THE CAPTAIN OF MY SOUL."

That is what Henley said in his famous poem *Invictus*.
QUESTION: What do you think of that line? Do you agree or disagree?

If we are the captains of our own souls, we have a lot to carry. One person considered what her life would look like without a relationship with God. She thought writing the opposite meaning of a chapter from the Bible described it well. Read her descriptive poem together, underline or make marks on significant words or phrases, then discuss the questions below.

I lead my own life. There's a lot that I want.

I'm looking for a place to lie in rest, but I can't find it. There's a lot that I worry about, swirling waters all around.

My soul is fragmented. I'm left wandering, not knowing where to go, not knowing right from wrong, living for myself yet going nowhere.

I walk by death all day long, there's a lot that I fear. I feel alone. The comforts I chase after are good only for a short while, then I'm empty inside again.

In the presence of my enemies, I'm put to shame. I feel no blessing, I feel empty inside.

I don't know where good is. I don't know what my final resting place will be. I hope I find it one day.

QUESTION: Which of these statements do you most identify with? What would life look like if that wasn't the case?

Next, do the same thing you did with the above poem with the real one, Psalm 23, on the next page, then discuss the questions below.

HOW MIGHT HOPE COME FROM KNOWING JESUS?

Psalm 23

The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing.

He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters, he refreshes my soul.

He guides me along the right paths for his name's sake.

Even though I walk through the darkest valley, I will fear no evil, for you are with me; your rod and your staff, they comfort me.

You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil; my cup overflows.

Surely your goodness and love will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

QUESTION: Since the LORD is another word for the name of Jesus, how might experiencing Jesus as your shepherd be better than you being the captain of your soul?

In another passage of the Bible, John 10:10-11, Jesus says:

"The (devil) comes only to steal and kill and destroy (the sheep); I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full. I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep."

QUESTION: Do you feel like you have the life that is being stolen, killed and destroyed; or the abundant life as described in Psalm 23? (Consider going back to compare and contrast Psalm 23 and the first version.)

NEXT STEPS:

- What takeaway do you have from thinking about and discussing the passages?
- Have you drawn any new conclusions about your life or who Jesus could be to you?
- For more information on how to receive forgiveness for your sins and receiving Jesus as your "good shepherd" as Lord and Savior - go over the "The Bridge to Life" illustration.

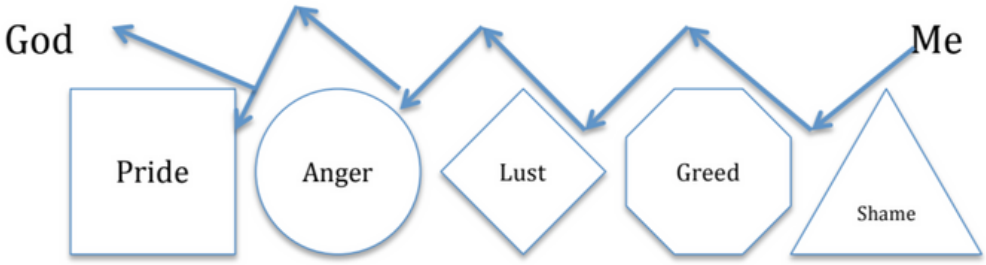
Evangelize

Gospel vs. Religion

What things about you do you wish God just didn't know or didn't see? These are often things that separate us from God. The shapes below represent these things.

Religion

When religion sees these things it tries to fix them through self-effort. Religion sees these issues as obstacles to be overcome. The religious person says, "I have to be better" and so they try to fix them through "being better" as seen in the arrows.



What does this result in?

1. Depression – Sure we'll make some progress in some areas but ultimately we will be overwhelmed by the progress that we cannot make. This results in depression as we throw up our hands in despair and quit since we cannot "make the grade".

2. Pride – For some of us we will make strides in some areas yet we will become frustrated with those who do not or choose not to make the same progress. This results in pride as we will see ourselves as better than these people. Think of the Pharisees in the time of Jesus and how they viewed others.

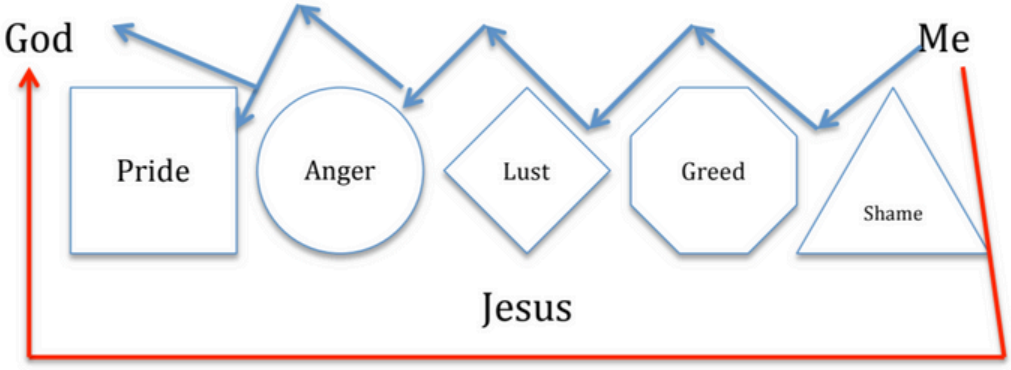
3. Unforgiveness – Similar to pride, there will be a lack of forgiveness on our part for those who choose not to grow. Why? Because we overcame it, they didn't, and we are tired of their excuses.

4. Duty – Our desire to change is driven by a duty to please God. We do it because we have to as we seek to earn his love or favor.

The Gospel or "Good News"

On the other hand the Gospel has nothing to do with you earning it. As the red line demonstrates (next page), Christ sees all of our mess, our shame, and our guilt yet He picks us up and places us right next to God. How? What about our shame, our sin? Well when God sees us now, He no longer sees our sin and shame, instead all He sees is Jesus' perfection. How? Because we choose to believe that Jesus died upon the cross for our sin/shame and rose from the dead on the third day. His perfection covers our imperfection. Ephesians 2:4-10 (next page) illustrates this as Paul tells us that God was rich in mercy so he covered our transgressions in Christ so that we may now be alive and seated next to Him in the heavenly realm. How do we receive this acceptance, this perfection? By faith in Jesus' sacrifice. He did it, we did nothing, and so we now gain everything. As verses eight and nine make clear, none of our full acceptance comes by works, it is all by faith in Christ so that none of us can boast of what we have done. In other words, there is no religion, no earning it.

Gospel vs. Religion



Ephesian 2:4-10 (NLT)

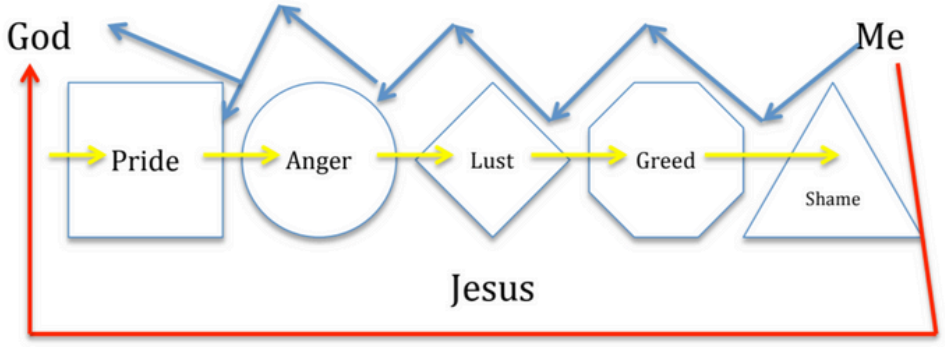
4 But God is so rich in mercy, and he loved us so much, 5 that even though we were dead because of our sins, he gave us life when he raised Christ from the dead. (It is only by God's grace that you have been saved!) 6 For he raised us from the dead along with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms because we are united with Christ Jesus. 7 So God can point to us in all future ages as examples of the incredible wealth of his grace and kindness toward us, as shown in all he has done for us who are united with Christ Jesus.

8 God saved you by his grace when you believed. And you can't take credit for this; it is a gift from God. 9 Salvation is not a reward for the good things we have done, so none of us can boast about it. 10 For we are God's masterpiece. He has created us anew in Christ Jesus, so we can do the good things he planned for us long ago

What does this result in?
1. Joy – Instead of being weighed down in despair by all we have to do to earn acceptance, we now have joy because we are fully accepted and fully loved.
2. Humility – Humility is "passion for God" whereas pride is "passion for self". Since Jesus paid it all and made me whole, I now have passion for him. I want to champion Him and not myself since He fully loves and accepts me.
3. Forgiveness – Since Jesus has fully forgiven me I am called to forgive others. If in his perfection He can forgive all my mess, then how can I in my imperfection not forgive another imperfect person?
4. Love – The opposite of duty. I don't seek to follow God and be like him because I have to, I do it because I want to. If you love your spouse you don't have to put reminders around the house to tell you to be affectionate, tell them you love them, or serve them. You just do it. Why? Because you love them.

Yet things do not stop there....

Now that we are fully accepted by God He is not content to leave us alone. He knows all our sin and shame, He knows our mess, yet He wants to transform it. He desires to make us into who He created us to be. As a result God will chisel away at those shameful parts for the rest of your life as represented by the yellow line. As Ephesians 2:10 states, "We are His workmanship, created to do good works in Christ Jesus". We are fully accepted and at the same time a work in progress as the Holy Spirit is transforming us into God's "workmanship". We are like a messy house on "Hoarders", God owns the property no matter what and He wants to clean us out. It will take a while and there is no way the job will be completed on this side of eternity, but nonetheless He is at work. Then when we are in His presence we will finally be what God intended: fully loved, fully accepted, and our "house" clean and beautiful.

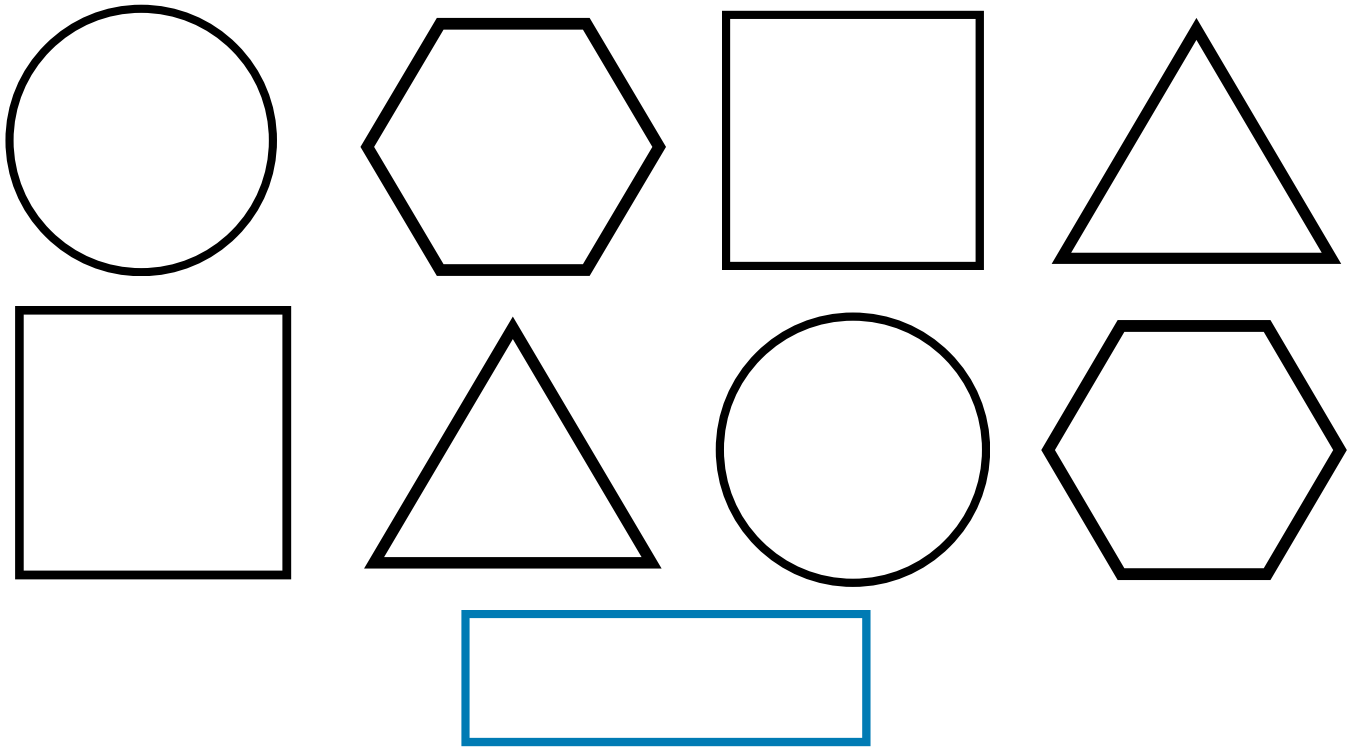


Evangelize

THE WELL ILLUSTRATION

"People follow, give themselves to, trust in whatever they believe will give them life." This illustration shows what the Bible has to say about our pursuit for life.

1. Where do you find life (i.e. satisfaction, security, love, significance, ...)? Write your answers in the different black shapes ("wells") below.
2. Read the verse below and define the following words / phrases: *forsaken*, *dug*, *cisterns*, *broken*, and *spring of living water*.
   What does Jesus have to say about our search for life? *See John 4:13-14*
3. Now looking back over the shapes ("wells"), answer the following questions:
   a. Why do you try to meet your needs in this "well"?
   b. When you have gone to this "well", what have you experienced or learned? Draw cracks in each of the shapes to signify that these will always fail us.
   c. What prevents you from going to Christ, the Spring of Living Water? Write Jesus in the bottom blue shape, with water spreading to all the other “wells”.



My people have committed two sins: They have forsaken me, the spring of living water, and have dug their own cisterns, broken cisterns that cannot hold water.
Jeremiah 2:13

Evangelize

FIVE ASSURANCES OF FAITH

1 John 3:19-20 [NIV]
"This is how we know that we belong to the truth and how we set our hearts at rest in his presence: If our hearts condemn us, **we know that God is greater than our hearts**, and he knows everything."

The Bible is full of key promises and assurances about who God is, who we are and our relationship with Him. Below are five key Biblical assurances for all Christians. If you have a relationship with Jesus these assurances are true of you no matter what you feel, what you've done (positive or negative) or what others have done to you. The fact of what God says of us is what we place our faith in, which in turn determines our feelings. Spend time reading through the verses below and reflect together on the following questions. How does faith in each of the assurances provide an anchor of comfort to you?

1 **Assurance of Salvation** *1 John 5:11-13*
Who are the two types of people in this passage? What makes them different? Where does life come from? How do we get it?

2 **Assurance of Answered Prayer** *John 16:24*
What do we need to do in order to "receive" an answer to our prayers? What is the difference between asking in someone else's name and Jesus' name? How are different ways that God could answer? Does answering mean I receive whatever I ask for?

3 **Assurance of Victory** *1 Corinthians 10:13*
Is your temptation unique to just you? How does God help us in the midst of temptation? Do you believe that God can empower you to overcome any sin? How is that seen in how you think & live?

4 **Assurance of Forgiveness** *1 John 1:9*
What are we called to do in this verse? What does God say in response? Are there limitations to what, when or how often He will forgive?

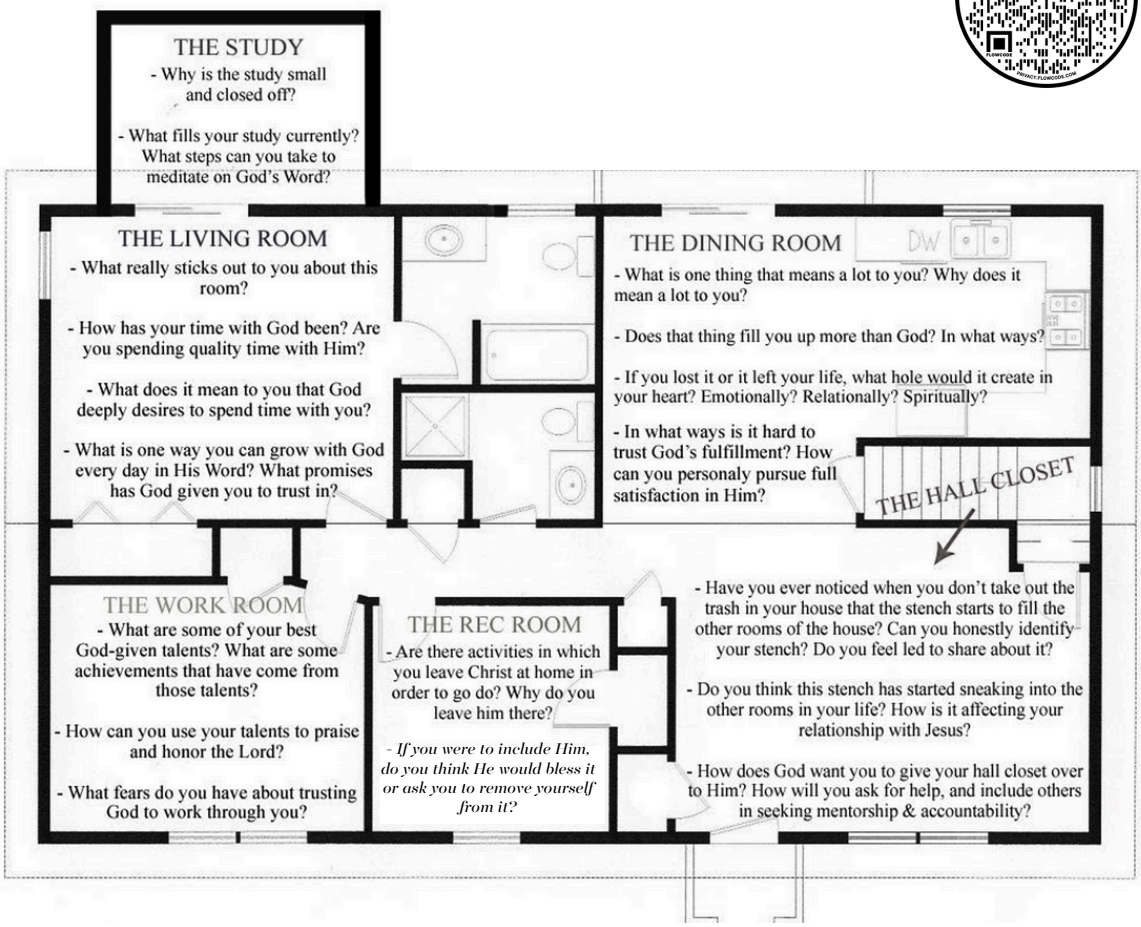
5 **Assurance of Guidance** *Proverbs 3:5-6*
What his God's role in this verse? What are we told to do/not do? Can we withhold any part of life from God? Why or why not?

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. Adapted from the Growing with Christ series.

Evangelize

MY HEART, CHRIST'S HOME

Inviting Jesus into our lives can be compared to inviting Him to live in our home. Jesus does not simply want to be a guest, but to own the home and shape us into the man or woman He perfectly designed us to be. Spend time either together or own your own reading through the short story My Heart, Christ's Home by Robert Munger (scan the QR code), then pick a room below to discuss.



ESTABLISH

Resources for those who are learning what it looks like to be a disciple of Jesus

navigators™

Establish

THE WHEEL

How you relate to yourself.

THE VOLITIONAL DIMENSION

- **THE HUB | CHRIST THE CENTER** Total surrender to Christ's authority and lordship is not always a decision made right away at conversion, but is a necessary act of will. For the believer, the "old life" has gone and the new life has come (2 Corinthians 5:17), and Christ dwells in and through us instead of ourselves (Galatians 2:20). God creates within us the desire to do what He wants us to do in order to express His lordship in our lives.

- **THE RIM | Obedience To Christ** Some acts of obedience to God are internal, such as attitudes, habits, motives, values, and day-to-day thoughts. But even these eventually surface outwardly in our relationships with other people. Keeping His commandments in obedience is our outward indication of inward health and love for Christ -- our worship (John 14:21, Romans 12:1).

How you relate to God.

THE VERTICAL DIMENSION

- **THE WORD SPOKE --** The Word of God is His direct voice showing us not only who He is, but how to live and interact with everyone around us (2 Timothy 3:16). This means an earnest personal intake of God's Word is essential for health and growth (Joshua 1:8). As God speaks to us through the Scriptures, we can see His principles for life and ministry, learn how to obey Him and see He is worthy of our steadfast allegiance.

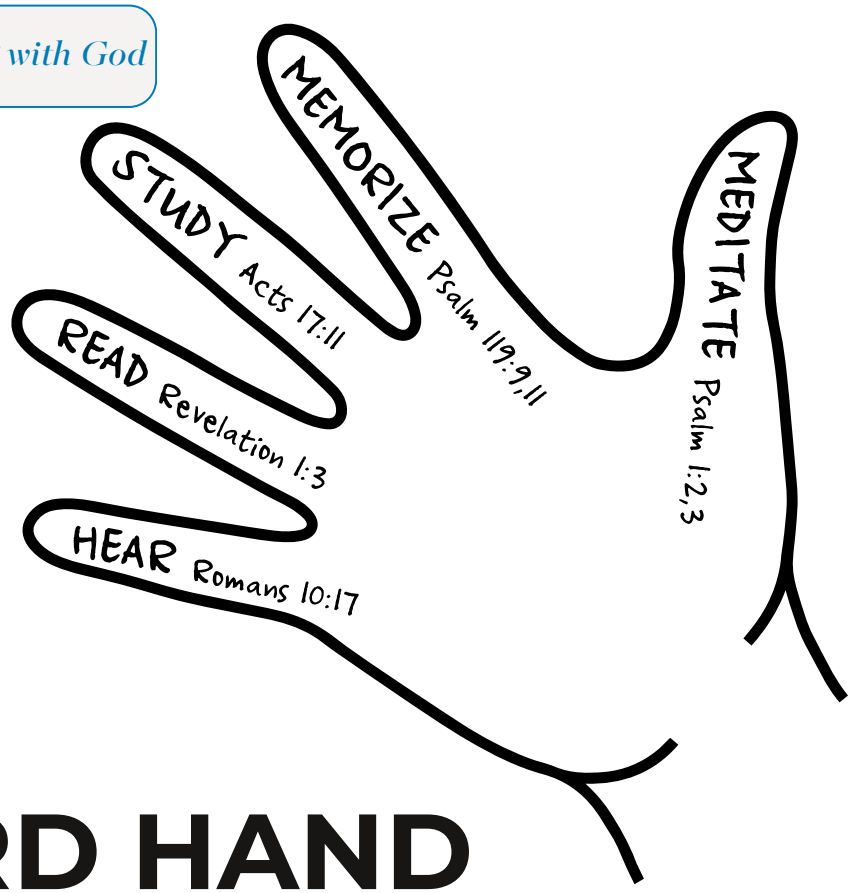
- **THE PRAYER SPOKE --** Prayer is the natural response to God as we hear Him speak through His Word. It is sharing our heart with the One who longs for our companionship and who cares about our concerns. Prayer not only trains our hearts and minds to know the power and glory of God, but also turns His ear towards action in our lives and of those who we pray for (John 15:7, Philippians 4:6-7).

How you relate to others.

THE HORIZONTAL DIMENSION

- **THE FELLOWSHIP SPOKE --** God has directed Christians to build each other up through inter-dependence and loving relationships with each other (Hebrews 10:24-25). Gathering as the Body of Christ draws God close around us as we praise Him and encourage one another (Matthew 18:20).

- **THE WITNESSING SPOKE --** God has given believers the joy and responsibility of telling the world about the Good News of Christ's work on earth (Matthew 4:19). In fact, sharing this spectacular news with others should be the natural overflow of a rich, vibrant life in Christ (Romans 1:16).



THE WORD HAND

The Word Hand illustration is an easy- to-remember tool highlighting five methods of learning from the Bible. Use it for your own spiritual growth and to share with someone else.

1 HEARING
the Word from pastors and teachers provides fresh insight into the Scriptures. The weakest finger—the pinkie—represents hearing, because we retain only 5 percent of what we hear. *Romans 10:17*

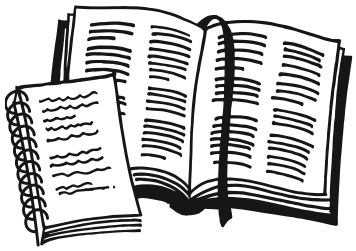
2 READING
gives us an overview of the Bible and is the foundation of a daily quiet time. This is represented by the ring finger. We generally retain 15 percent of what we read. *Revelation 1:3*

3 STUDYING
the Scriptures deepens our convictions. It requires greater time and effort but results in increased Bible knowledge. Most people retain 35 percent of what they study. This is represented by the middle finger. *Acts 17:11*

4 MEMORIZING
God's Word enables us to use the Sword of the Spirit to overcome temptations and to have verses readily available for ministering to others. The index finger, our strongest finger, represents memorization. We remember 100 percent of what we memorize if we consistently review it. *Psalm 119:9–11*

5 MEDITATION
is the inward process that accompanies each of the other four methods of Scripture intake. This is why meditation is assigned to the thumb. Only the thumb can touch all the other four fingers. By meditating on God's Word as we hear, read, study, and memorize, we discover its transforming power at work in us. *Psalm 1:2,3*

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/word-hand



DAILY TIME WITH GOD

One of the most important, if not THE most important Spiritual habit for growth is spending daily time with God. Through Jesus Christ each of us have direct access to the God of the universe, who WANTS to spend time with us! And through God's inspired Word, the Bible, we can know everything He desires to say to us!

The Bible does not need to be intimidating! The Bible is a collection of 66 books written over the course of 2,000 years, across three continents in three different languages, all telling one unified story of the God of the universe saving His people. Over time, Bible translators have added chapters and verses to help readers navigate around the Bible easier.

QUIET TIME SANDWICH

One helpful way to think about reading the Bible everyday is to envision a sandwich, with the bread being **prayer** and the meat being **reading the Bible**.

1. Begin by **praying** and asking God to open your eyes to what He wants to show you.

2. Next, spend time **reading** a section of scripture. It is helpful to begin in a Gospel (Matthew, Mark, Luke or John), and simply read one or a few chapters a day. Consider the **SOAP** acronym: **summarize**, **observe**, **apply**, **process**. You will likely find it helpful to have a journal nearby to record any thoughts.

3. End your time by **praying**, reflecting over any thoughts or actions that came to mind while reading.

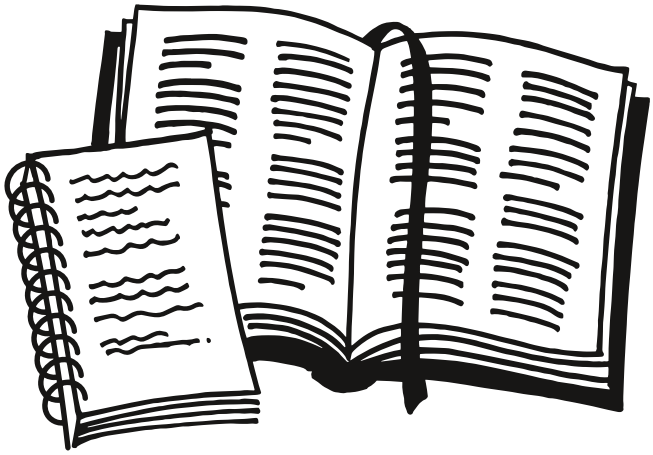
NEXT STEPS

Consider the following three questions to help this become a habit in your life!

TIME: Have a regular time to spend with Jesus picked out ahead of time.

PLAN: What will you read? Consider reading one chapter in both the New and Old Testament.

PLACE: Pick a location free from distraction where you'll be able to meet with God.



One of the best ways to study the Bible is through "inductive" study. This method makes observations on a passage of Scripture and then draws conclusions based on those observations.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY

These steps follow the inductive method's process of observation, interpretation, and application.

1. BACKGROUND

Who is the author? Why was it written? Learn the historical background, dates, key people and so on. Some Bibles have summaries at the beginning of each book that will provide some of this information. A Bible dictionary or online commentary can also be helpful.

2. PERSONAL PARAPHRASE

Write out each verse or section of verses in your own words. This helps you understand each verse in wording that makes more sense to you.

Example:
Original Verse: "Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the command of God our Savior and of Christ Jesus our hope … " (1 Timothy 1:1 NIV).

Personal Paraphrase:
Paul, a proclaimer of Jesus Christ, obeying the instructions of God who is the One who saves us, and of Jesus Christ who is our hope.

3. QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Write down and then answer any questions you have about the passage or any confusing terms.

Example:
(Q) What does the word "apostle" mean? What does it mean to be one?

(A) The Greek word apostolos comes from the verb apostello, which means "to send forth." So to be an apostle means to be someone who is sent forth—in this case by Christ to spread His message.

4. CROSS REFERENCES

Make note of any similar or related passages that come to mind while you're reading, paraphrasing, and asking questions about the passage. Consult a concordance, study guide, or footnotes to collect additional related passages.

Example:
Apostle: 2 Corinthians 1:1
God my Savior: Titus 1:3
Christ our hope: Colossians 1:27

5. INSIGHTS

If you observe something that relates to any part of the passage, write it down. *After* completing your own thoughts and analysis, consult a Bible commentary for additional insight.

Example: Paul was commanded by God to be an apostle. It wasn't something he decided to do on his own.

6. PERSONAL APPLICATION

Example: (1 Timothy 1:1): Just like Paul, I need to see that I'm tasked with being Christ's ambassador, authorized and sent out with a divine message. I'll only be effective in my mission if I'm aware of my status as a divinely appointed witness.

7. TITLE & SUMMARIZE

After completing a verse-by-verse analysis of a chapter, give it a title and identify a key verse or verses. This helps solidify the chapter's message in your mind. Write a summary paragraph outlining the chapter's thesis. Repeat the process for each chapter until the book is completed, and then give it a collective title.

Try these tools out in this study of Romans!

MEMORIZE GOD'S WORD

When God's people allow their lives to be led by God's word, they will know their God and in turn live God-glorifying lives. This theme is pervasive all throughout the narrative of scripture. In Deuteronomy, Moses states: "man does not live by bread alone, but by every word that comes from the mouth of God" (8:3b) and later states, "For it is no empty word for you, but your very life" (32:47). In the era of Kings, we see what happens to kings (and to the kingdom of Israel) when they remember God's word and when they do not, resulting in generational "flip-flops" of convictions, lifestyles and intimacy with their creator. When the Kingdom finally falls to Babylon, the prophet Jeremiah lives as an incredible example of knowing the character of God.

READ: Lamentations 3:17-24

- What do you notice about Jeremiah's feelings?
- What do you think Jeremiah knows about God?
- What do you notice about Jeremiah's faith?

Jeremiah's *faith* in the *facts* of scripture (truth about who God is and what He desires) allows him to order his *feelings* in their proper place (not stuff them down, let them rule his life, or change his view of God).

Although we do not see Jeremiah explicitly memorize scripture, it is clear that he knows God's word and even God himself despite his circumstances. Scripture memory is one of the most prominent ways in which we can tether ourselves to what is true about God, ourselves, and our circumstances.

PRACTICE: Build your own tether in God's word

FACT Who I am in Christ:
2 Corinthians 5:17 - "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; the old is gone, behold the new has come"

- Is this true sometimes or all the time? Just for Corinth or for me too?
- Do I believe this to be true? **FAITH**
- How would believing it to be true change my relationship to God? Myself? Circumstances (i.e. suffering, excitement, etc.)? **FEELING**

APPLY: Tool for more tethers

The Navigators has always encouraged Bible memorization as an important tool for spiritual growth and for sharing truth with friends. The Topical Memory System (TMS) by NavPress has been used by generations of disciples to hide God's Word in their hearts.

Apps ...
Now, you can access TMS on apps for your iPhone or Android. Find the apps in the Apple store or Play store (search Navigators Topical Memory System). Memorize and review verses on the go!

... or Cards
Prefer the printed Topical Memory System? It is available through Navpress.com.
Or the complete list of verses is on the next page.

TOPICAL MEMORY SYSTEM

LIVING THE NEW LIFE

Christ the Center	*2 Corinthians 5:17*	*Galatians 2:20*
Obedience to Christ	*Romans 12:1*	*John 14:21*
The Word	*2 Timothy 3:16*	*Joshua 1:8*
Prayer	*John 15:7*	*Philippians 4:6,7*
Fellowship	*Matthew 18:20*	*Hebrews 10:24,25*
Witnessing	*Matthew 4:19*	*Romans 1:16*

PROCLAIMING CHRIST

All Have Sinned	*Romans 3:23*	*Isaiah 53:6*
Sin's Penalty	*Romans 6:23*	*Hebrews 9:27*
Christ Paid the Penalty	*Romans 5:8*	*1 Peter 3:18*
Salvation is not by Works	*Ephesians 2:8,9*	*Titus 3:5*
Must Receive Christ	*John 1:12*	*Revelation 3:20*
Assurance of Salvation	*1 John 5:13*	*John 5:24*

RELIANCE ON GOD'S RESOURCES

His Spirit	*1 Corinthians 3:16*	*1 Corinthians 2:12*
His Strength	*Isaiah 41:10*	*Philippians 4:13*
His Faithfulness	*Lamentations 3:22,23*	*Numbers 23:19*
His Peace	*Isaiah 26:3*	*1 Peter 5:7*
His Provision	*Romans 8:32*	*Philippians 4:19*
His Help in Temptation	*Hebrews 2:18*	*Psalms 119:9,11*

BECOMING CHRIST'S DISCIPLE

Put Christ First	*Matthew 6:33*	*Luke 9:23*
Separate From the World	*1 John 2:15,16*	*Romans 12:2*
Be Steadfast	*1 Corinthians 15:58*	*Hebrews 12:3*
Serve Others	*Mark 10:45*	*2 Corinthians 4:5*
Give Generously	*Proverbs 3:9,10*	*2 Corinthians 9:6,7*
Develop World Vision	*Acts 1:8*	*Matthew 28:19,20*

GROWTH IN CHRISTLIKENESS

Love	*John 13:34,35*	*1 John 3:18*
Humility	*Philippians 2:3,4*	*1 Peter 5:5,6*
Purity	*Ephesians 5:3*	*1 Peter 2:11*
Honesty	*Leviticus 19:11*	*Acts 24:16*
Faith	*Hebrews 11:6*	*Romans 4:20,21*
Good Works	*Galatians 6:9,10*	*Matthew 5:16*

A.C.T.S. - *PRAYER TOOL*

Prayer can be intimidating when you first start: knowing what to say and how to approach God. At its core, prayer is just talking and listening to God - there are no magic words or postures necessary. This A.C.T.S. tool is not the only way to pray, but is a simple tool to develop the discipline and delight of prayer. There is no set time for each aspect, but as you grow in prayer don't be surprised if you find yourself spending more and more time doing it.

Pray out loud or in your head, by yourself or with a friend, on a walk or sitting down journaling. No matter how you do it, enjoy time with our Heavenly Father who is eager to listen and speak to you.

I love the Lord, for He heard my voice; He heard my cry for mercy.
Because He turned His ear to me, I will call on Him as long as I live.
Psalm 116:1-2

A

ADORATION

Let enjoyment and praise of God overflow into words. Starting here reminds us of who God is and impacts the following aspects.

"Praise the Lord. Praise the Lord, my soul. I will praise the Lord all my life; I will sing praise to my God as long as I live."
Psalm 146:1-2

C

CONFESSION

Repent of intentional and unintentional sins, knowing God is eager to forgive. If none come to mind, ask God to search your heart for any offenses.

"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all un-righteousness."
1 John 1:9

T

THANKSGIVING

Thank God for what He is doing, what He has given, and how He will continue to work - in your life, the lives of others, and around the world. We adore Him for who He IS; we thank Him for what He DOES.

"...always giving thanks to God the Father for everything, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."
Ephesians 5:20

S

SUPPLICATION

Ask God to provide for your needs. Intercede on behalf of friends, family, and the world as a whole.

"And I will do whatever you ask in my name, so that the Father may be glorified in the Son. You may ask me for anything in my name, and I will do it."
John 14:13-14

PRAYER MAP

Why should we spend time praying for other people?

- We have uninterrupted, unlimited access to the Father through Jesus. (1 John 2:1; Hebrews 7:25)
  What is an advocate? How is Jesus our advocate? How can we advocate for others?

- God wants us to approach Him. (Hebrews 4:16; Psalm 25:14)
  If you truly believed God wanted you to approach Him, how would that change your prayer life?

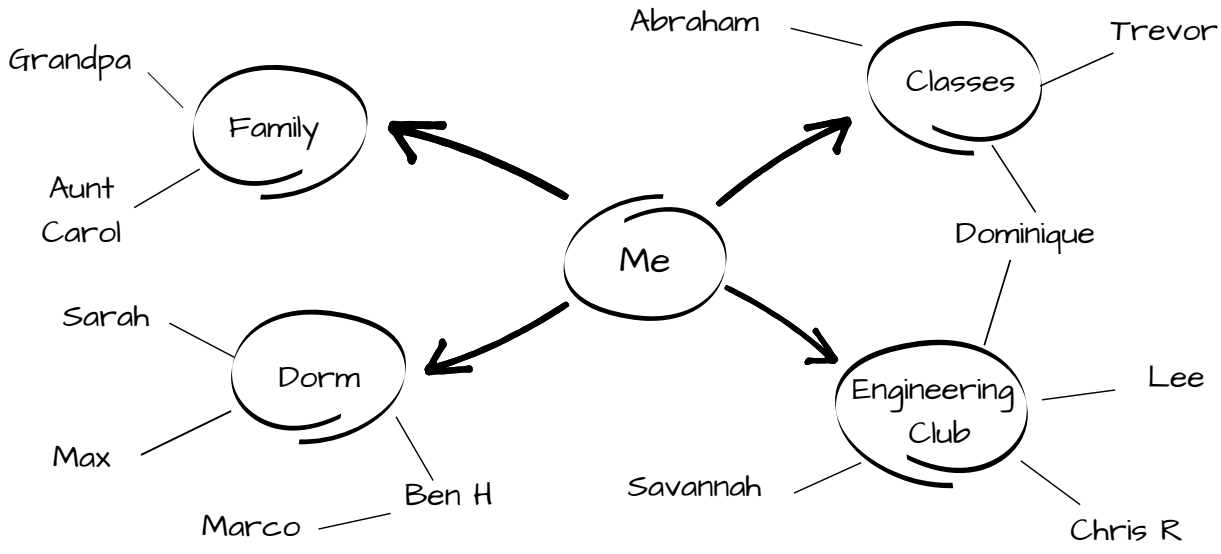
- The work of transforming people's lives is not difficult; it's impossible. (Matthew 19:26)
  When we try to do the work of God without prayer, what does that reveal about our heart?

God has a reason for where He has placed you. Who in your life can you impact for the sake of Christ?
A prayer map keeps our mind focused on the people God has placed around us and reminds us to intercede for them every day.

Create Your Own Prayer Map

1. Begin by writing your name in the middle and drawing a circle around it.
2. Think of the contexts you have around you to meet other people. This could be things like: Neighborhood/Dorm, Work, Class, Church, Family, etc.
3. Write in names of people you know from each of these spheres who do not know Jesus yet. As you meet new people, keep adding them to the map.
4. Put this prayer map where you will see it often and start by praying for 2-3 people each day.

EXAMPLE



IDENTITY IN CHRIST

Who are you? What makes you, you? What do you want to be known for? What are you seeking after? These are questions most of us will wrestle with in life. In a lot of ways, how you answer will determine what "living" looks like for you.

But who does God say you are? And why does that even matter?

ISAIAH 45:8-12

Read and make observations on the pot and the maker. (Tip: look at multiple translations for better understanding.)

_____

_____

3 main takeaways:

1. God made us
2. He did it on purpose
3. As Creator, He defines our identity which then determines our purpose or what we live for.

Let's look at a Bible character and see how she would answer the questions we observed above:

JOHN 4:1-30

Read and make observations on her identity and desires and how Jesus addresses them.

_____

_____

Key Questions and Answers from this Story:

Who is she?

- Outcast, Samaritan, unloved or even unlovable.

What is she seeking after in life?

- Belonging, love, to be fully known and still completely loved.

How does Jesus respond?

- He essentially says, "I already know you and love you completely and I will satisfy all your desires. Just come to me." He offers her a better identity and true satisfaction.

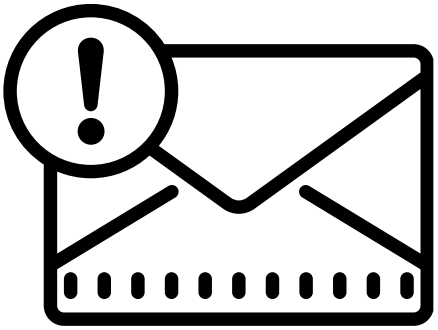
What does it cost her to get what Jesus offers her for identity and satisfaction?

- Everything! Her current identity and ways to be satisfied need to be replaced. She can't be "outcast, (rest of list)" any more and she can't keep looking to others to satisfy her. She must find that in Jesus.

What does this mean for us?

God asks us to give up our identity and desires because He offers something better and more secure. Is this something you want? What would it take for you to trust God with all of yourself?

**For more verses on who God says you are and what purpose He has for your life, scan the QR code.



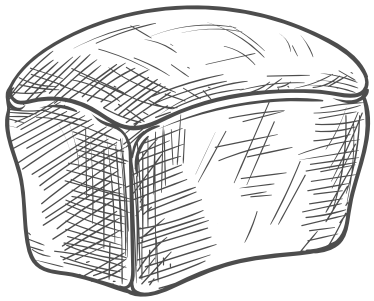
TYRANNY OF THE URGENT

How we use our time reveals our true priorities and what we believe about God. We may say that we prioritize God, His Word and His people, but do our actions show that? Spend time either together or own your own reading through the article **Tyranny of the Urgent** by Charles E. Hummel (link below). Stop after every few sections to discuss your observations and thoughts, then answer the questions below.

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

1. What things are important in your life? What things are urgent? Take time to write down areas of your life that you would categorize as either urgent or important.
2. Begin with your “big rocks” first. What important areas of life are you not making time for? How can you add those as first priority into your life?
3. What things in your life are un-urgent, unimportant, and are sucking away time from the important? What limitations or boundaries would be helpful to establish in these areas (consider areas such as media and phone use, video games, etc)?
4. An old Navigator once said “Not every bag that comes through baggage claim has your name on it.” What are some bags that you’ve picked up that God hasn’t asked you to pick up?
5. What things are you avoiding that would serve you by having on your weekly calendar? (*James 4:17)*
6. Create a schedule for the next week based on your priorities. Keep a time log to see how you actually spent your time and compare it to the schedule. What went well? What didn't go well? Are there adjustments that need to be made for the next week?

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. **Adapted from Tyranny of the Urget by Charles Hummel.**



FASTING IN SCRIPTURE

Fasting is intended to take our eyes off our physical needs/desires and fix our eyes on Jesus. Temporarily giving up things that we often depend on (i.e. food, caffeine, social media, etc) can help us to refocus on our Creator and what He has for us.

> *Whenever you fast, don't be gloomy like the hypocrites. For they make their faces unattractive so that their fasting is obvious to people. Truely I tell you, they have their reward. But when you fast, put oil on your head and wash your face, so that your fasting isn't obvious to others but to your Father who is in secret. And your Father who sees in secret will reward you.*
> *Matthew 6:16-18*

Read through the following passages together making observations about different purposes of fasting.

1 Fasting in Confession and Repentance

"Jonah set out on the first day of his walk in the city and proclaimed 'In forty days Nineveh will be demolished!' Then the people of Nineveh believed God. They proclaimed a fast and dressed in sackcloth -- from the greatest of them to the least." Jonah 3:4-5 *(See also Nehemiah 9:1-2)*

2 Fasting During a Period of Mourning

"Then David took hold of his clothes and tore them, and all the men with him did the same. They mourned, wept, and fasted until the evening for those who died by the sword--for Saul, his son Jonathan, the Lord's people, and the house of Israel." 2 Samuel 1:11-12 *(See also 1 Samuel 31:12-13)*

3 Fasting to Seek the Lord's Favor

"Esther sent this reply to Mordecai: 'Go and assemble all the Jews who can be found in Susa and fast for me. Don't eat or drink for three days, night or day. I and my female servants will also fast in the same way. After that, I will go to the king even if it is against the law. If I perish, I perish."
Esther 4:15-16 *(See also Joel 1:13-15)*

4 Fasting as a Part of Worship

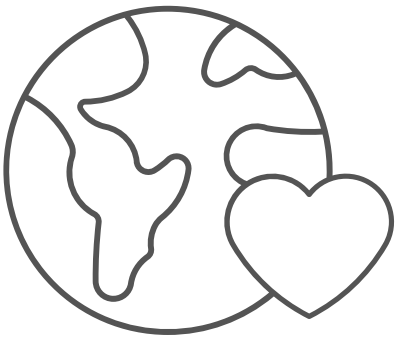
"There was also a prophetess, Anna, a daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was well along in years, having lived with her husband seven years after her marriage, and was a widow for eighty-four years. She did not leave the temple, serving God night and day with fasting and prayers."
Luke 2:36-37 *(See also Acts 14:23)*

5 Fasting to Demonstrate Reliance upon God

"Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. After he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was hungry." Matthew 4:1-2

What stood out to you most about fasting? How would you like to incorporate this spiritual discipline into the rhythms of your life? For what reason are you most compelled to fast?

For further study and help getting started, read through the linked article on fasting!



DEVELOPING A HEART FOR THE LOST

"The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want." Psalm 23:1

What a sweet truth to know that it is the LORD who guides us. He is by our side, protecting us, caring for us, loving us. We have security in Him. But how would it feel if that wasn't true for you? If the opposite was true? "I am my own shepherd and I can't get enough of what I want." That is the reality of our unbelieving friends and the lost people all around us.

PSALM 23

Spend some time in Psalm 23. Rewrite each verse from the perspective of someone who doesn't know God. (ex. "I am my own shepherd;" "My parents or friends are the ones leading me.")

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

1. What stuck out to you?
2. How did this make you feel? How do you think someone who isn't a believer would feel if they understood this reality?
3. How do you think God views the lost? How does this change how you view the lost?
4. Who in your life does this make you think of? (Consult your prayer map/list.)
5. How can you better love your unbelieving friends in light of this?
6. What would it cost you?

"'I am the good shepherd. I know my own and my own know me, just as the Father knows me and I know the Father; and I lay down my life for the sheep. And I have other sheep too that are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will listen to my voice. So there will be one flock, one shepherd." John 10:14-16

Jesus is the shepherd leading and ultimately responsible over the sheep. He cares more about finding the lost sheep than we do and He has a plan to bring them into the flock.

Pray now for those not in the flock yet.

SHARING YOUR TESTIMONY

Always be prepared to give an answer to everyone who asks you to give the reason for the hope that you have. 1 Peter 3:15

A testimony is the story of how Jesus saved you and why the gospel is good news for you personally. Our individual stories are some of the most powerful discipleship and evangelism tools because they are so deeply unique to us, yet can be relatable to others! As you begin to work on this, ask the Lord for wisdom and insight into just how to share your unique story. After completing the three sections, put them together into one cohesive, 3-5 minute long story. Then practice sharing your stories together!

BEFORE

Before you met Jesus, what was broken, disappointing, and/or missing from your life? What was one way you tried to solve that on your own?

GOSPEL STATEMENT

Our testimony should always center on Jesus and His gospel, making Him the hero of our story. The gospel is the good news that people, broken by living apart from God's created design, can be restored to life-giving relationship with God now and eternally by believing in the perfect life, death, and resurrection of Jesus Christ and submitting to Him as Lord. It is one message, but multifaceted in its effects and implications. ***In one sentence, why is the gospel good news to you personally?***

Examples:

- *"I am adopted as God's child through the works of Jesus Christ." (Romans 8:14)*
- *"Jesus gives me a new identity that is rooted in His perfection." (Galatians 2:20)*
- *"Jesus died for me even when I was his enemy, because He loves me." (Romans 5:8)*

For a list of gospel statements, scan the QR code

AFTER

What is one specific way your life is different in light of your gospel statement? What does your relationship with Jesus look like now?

GOD'S HEART FOR THE NATIONS

God's Word

God's Word is central to establishing our foundation. As a follower of Christ, our aim is to make God's purpose our purpose, and find our story in the greater story God has for the world. Look up and make observations about the following verses.

- Genesis 12:1-2
- Psalm 67:1-2
- Isaiah 49:6
- Matthew 28:19-20
- Matthew 24:14
- Revelation 7:9

After reading through each of the verses, how would you describe God's purpose on this earth?

God's World

To best step into God's story for the world, it is helpful to know the current state of the world (as of 2024).

- The 10/40 window is the rectangular area of North Africa, the Middle East, and Asia approximately between 10 degrees north and 40 degrees north (latitude). One-third of the earth's total land area and nearly two-thirds of the world's people live in the 10/40 window.
- 90% of the people living in the 10/40 Window are un-evangelized. Many have never heard the Gospel message and don't know any Christians. If those groups are to be evangelized, believers will need to leave their own culture, perhaps even learning a new language, in order to communicate the gospel.
- 80% of the poorest people in the world live in this window (living on less than $500 per year).
- 60% of international students come from this area of the world.
- 8% of the world's Christian missionaries work in the 10/40 Window.
- Only $0.01 out of every $100 given to missions goes to take the Gospel to unreached people living in this part of the world.

GOD'S HEART FOR THE NATIONS

An easy way to remember the five major world religons is the acronym THUMB:

Religion	Population (2024)
Tribal	400 Million
Hindu	1.2 Billion
Unreligious	1.1 Billion
Muslim	1.9 Billion
Buddhist	535 Million

What stood out to you about God's World?

God's Work

In light of God's word and the needs in God's world, there is great need to be engaged in God's story around the world. Believers can practice these five habits listed below to engage in God's global work.

1. **Goer** -- One who goes to one of the unreached people groups.
2. **Sender** -- One who supports those who go through prayer, service and finances.
3. **Prayer** -- One who prays for the advancement of God's Kingdom in the world.
4. **Welcomer** -- One who works with internationals here.
5. **Mobilizer** -- One who recruits others to embrace God's heart for the nations.

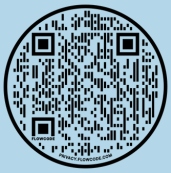
Discussion

- How would you evaluate yourself in the following areas (consider a 1-10 scale, with 1 being little to no interest or involvement and 10 being a word Christian).

    1. The biblical basis for missions.
    2. The current status of world evangelization
    3. The various habits/roles of being a world Christian

- Where do you think God wants you on this scale? Why?
- How will you get from where you are now to where God wants you? What is your plan?
- What do you think are some of the obstacles and sacrifices you may have to make to get there?
- Consider the resources below. What are 1 or 2 resources you would like to incorporate into your life in order to grow in this area?

Additional resources



BECOMMING A SERVANT

Is it more important to be a leader who serves, or a servant who leads? What would you say are the differences?

Jesus says in Mark 10:45, "Even the Son of man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many." In the verse before this, Jesus tells his disciples that in order to be first, they must be the "slave of all." Jesus not only spoke of serving others, but demonstrated through His own life what a servant looks like. Jesus modeled that serving others is something that must come out of our identity as who we are (i.e. a servant), not simply something we occasionally choose to do.

Spend time reading through John 13:1-17 and discuss the passage together. Then take time on your own to read the article "**What Made you Cross**" and consider the reflection questions.

What Made you Cross

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

1. What example challenged you the most / made you the most uncomfortable?
2. Where in your life do you notice yourself living to be served rather than to serve?
3. Where in your life, by God's grace, have you seen yourself genuinely serve someone else without the expectation of being served?
4. What does it look like for self to die and Christ to live today?

BUILDING FRIENDSHIPS

The word “friendship” rarely appears in scripture (5 times in the ESV). Instead we find the phrase “one another” in reference to our relationship with others (159 times in the ESV). Out of the overflow of what Christ has done for us, we can love, honor, encourage and submit humbly to one another; this is the basis for any biblical friendship.

**Scan the QR code to see a compiled list of 20 “one anothers” in Scripture.

3 Principles for Building Friendships

1. Courageous Vulnerability (How would you define it?)

1 John 1:6-7 “If we say we have fellowship with him while we walk in darkness, we lie and do not practice the truth. But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light we have fellowship with one another and the blood of Jesus his son cleanses us from all sin.”

Observations:_____(Ex: there is a relationship between the light and fellowship)

Application:_____ (Ex: What would it look like to lead with vulnerability instead of wait for others’ vulnerability?)

2. Persistent Intentionality (How would you define it?)

Hebrews 10:24-25- “Let us consider how to spur one another to love and good works, not neglecting to meet together as is the habit of some but encouraging one another, and all the more as you see the day drawing near”

Observations:_____(Ex: the first exhortation is “to consider”)

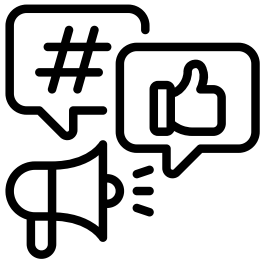
Application:_____ (Ex: “Consider” ways to initiate time with a friend, or carry the burden of planning a time to hangout)

3. Costly Humility (How would you define it?)

Ephesians 5:21 - “...submitting to one another out of reverence for Christ”
Proverbs 20:5 - “The purpose in a man's heart is like deep water, but a man of understanding will draw it out.”

Observations:_____(Ex: a man’s heart has waters they cannot search out alone)

Application:_____ (Ex: Invite someone to call out blind spots to sin in your life and avoid defensiveness. Ask a friend for help)

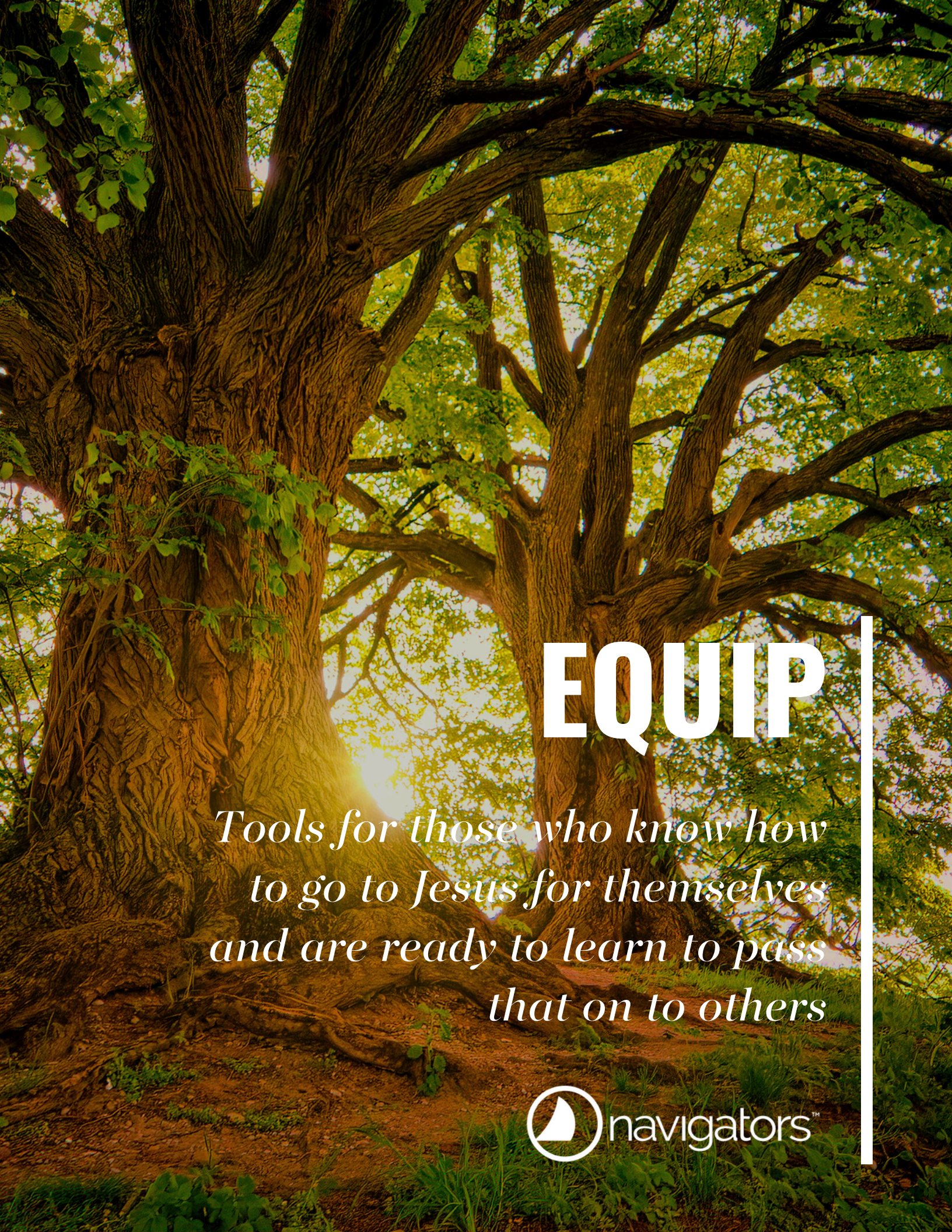


SOLOMON ON SOCIAL MEDIA

The Bible offers timeless truths that wisely instruct our present day decisions. The book of Proverbs, written by King Solomon, continues to offer wisdom to the modern day reader.

Consider the verses and principles below. How might that principle apply to the modern day user of social media?

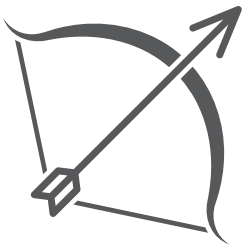
Verse	Principle	Application
Proverbs 29:20	***Don't speak in haste.*** *Count to ten before posting, sharing, sending, submitting, etc.*	
Proverbs 26:4	***Leave the fool to his folly.*** *Sometimes it's best not to give ammunition to someone picking a fight.*	
Proverbs 26:5	***Expose folly.*** *There are times when folly must be exposed, either if they are truly seeking wisdom, or are damaging others.*	
Proverbs 29:9	***Know when to walk away,*** *whether that means shutting down, logging off, blocking, etc.*	
Proverbs 26:8	***Be careful what you read.*** *Foolish people may seem wise, but they will still lead others astray.*	
Proverbs 29:22	***Avoid the gossiper.*** *Pursue what is noble rather than dishonorable.*	
Proverbs 27:2; 29:23	***Be humble.*** *Those who are humble and lowly in spirit will receive honor, while the arrogant will be brought low.*	
Proverbs 26:17	***Mind your own business.*** *Grabbing a stray dog by the ears will bring even more trouble; stay out of others' fights.*	
Proverbs 26:27	***Don't be a troublemaker.*** *Those who exist only to bring trouble to others will pay the price.*	
Proverbs 28:26	***Walk with the Lord.*** *Be a wise man or woman of the Word, rather than a fool who trusts in his or her own wisdom.*	



EQUIP

Tools for those who know how to go to Jesus for themselves and are ready to learn to pass that on to others

navigators™



YOU CAN MAKE DISCIPLES

Barna research lists the top five reasons Christians are not interested in being disciple makers.

1. Don't feel qualified or equipped.
2. Don't feel they would be very good at it.
3. Don't feel like they know enough about the Bible.
4. Don't feel like they know how to disciple someone.
5. Discipling someone is a job for church leaders or professional ministers.

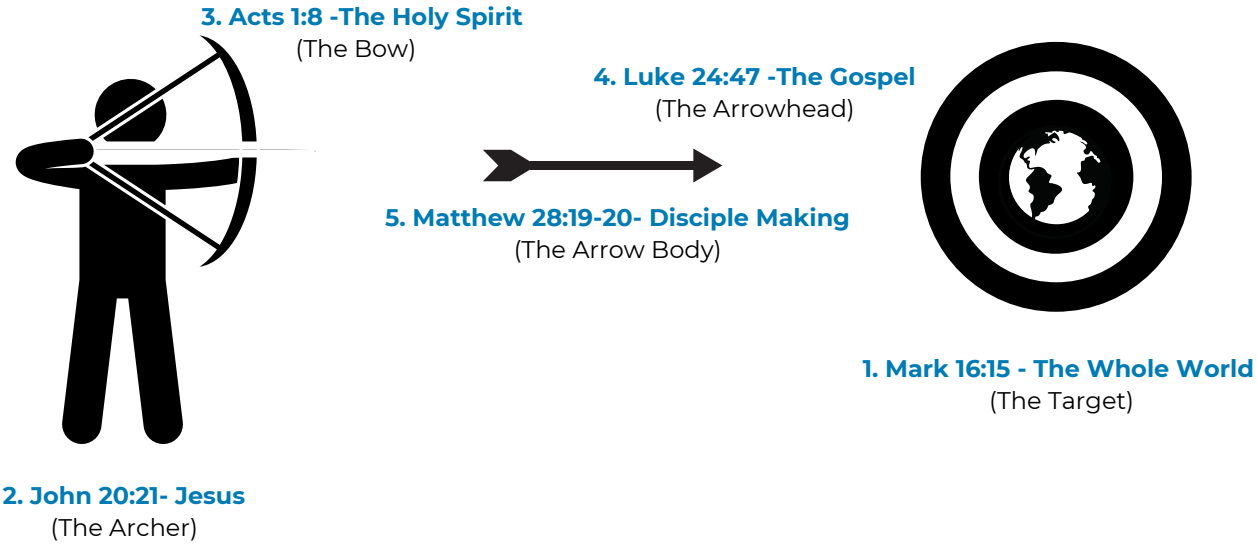
Which of these five reasons do you most identify with?

Making disciples can be intimidating. Thankfully, God has given several promises from His Word for every believer highlighting His desire to use everyday men and women to make disciples! This is illustrated below in the Archer Illustration.

Archer Illustration

Did you know there are 5 commision passages of Jesus? Note the similarities and what makes each commission unique.

1. Mark 16:15
2. John 20:21
3. Acts 1:8
4. Luke 24:47
5. Matthew 28:19-20



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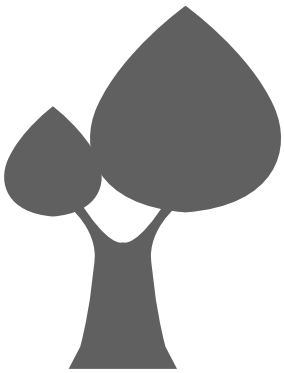


BORN TO REPRODUCE

"And the things you have heard me say in the presence of many witnesses entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others."
2 Timothy 2:2

Four generations are included in this verse that Paul wrote to Timothy.

1 Paul → 2 Timothy → 3 Reliable people → 4 Others

Consider the questions below:

- Why do you think Paul implored Timothy to find "reliable" people?
- What would have been the result of Timothy not finding reliable people to pass the message along to?

Born to Reproduce

In 1933, Dawson Trotman and his friends began working with sailors in the U.S. Navy. There, Dawson taught sailor Les Spencer the foundations of Christian growth. They spent many hours together praying, studying the Bible, and memorizing Scripture. When one of Spencer's shipmates asked him the secret of his changed life, Spencer brought the man to Trotman: "Teach him what you taught me," to which Dawson said, "You teach him!"

Spencer did teach the sailor, and soon the two men were meeting with others. Eventually, 125 men on their ship, the U.S.S. West Virginia, were growing in Christ and actively sharing their faith. By the end of World War II, thousands of men on ships and bases around the world were learning the principles of spiritual multiplication by the person-to-person teaching of God's word.

Spend time reading Dawson Trotman's 1955 talk Born to Reproduce and discussing the questions below:

Questions for Discussion

1. What stood out to you the most from this message?
2. What does the word "reproducer" mean to you?
3. What would help you the most right now in becoming a "reproducer?" Are there any changes you would make in your life or ministry?
4. What will you be asking God for this year?

Equip

THE NEED OF THE HOUR

"Call to me and I will answer you and tell you great and unsearchable things you do not know." Jeremiah 33:3

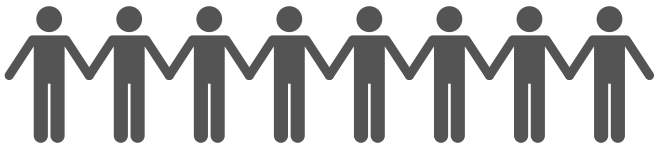
What is the greatest need of the hour in order to see God's main job of freeing an enslaved world? Is it more resources? More money? Greater justice from people and authorities? Dawson Trotman, the founder of The Navigators, speaks on Jeremiah 33:3 and addresses what he sees as the greatest need in God's Kingdom. Scan the code below to access the pdf to read and discuss.

The Need of the Hour

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

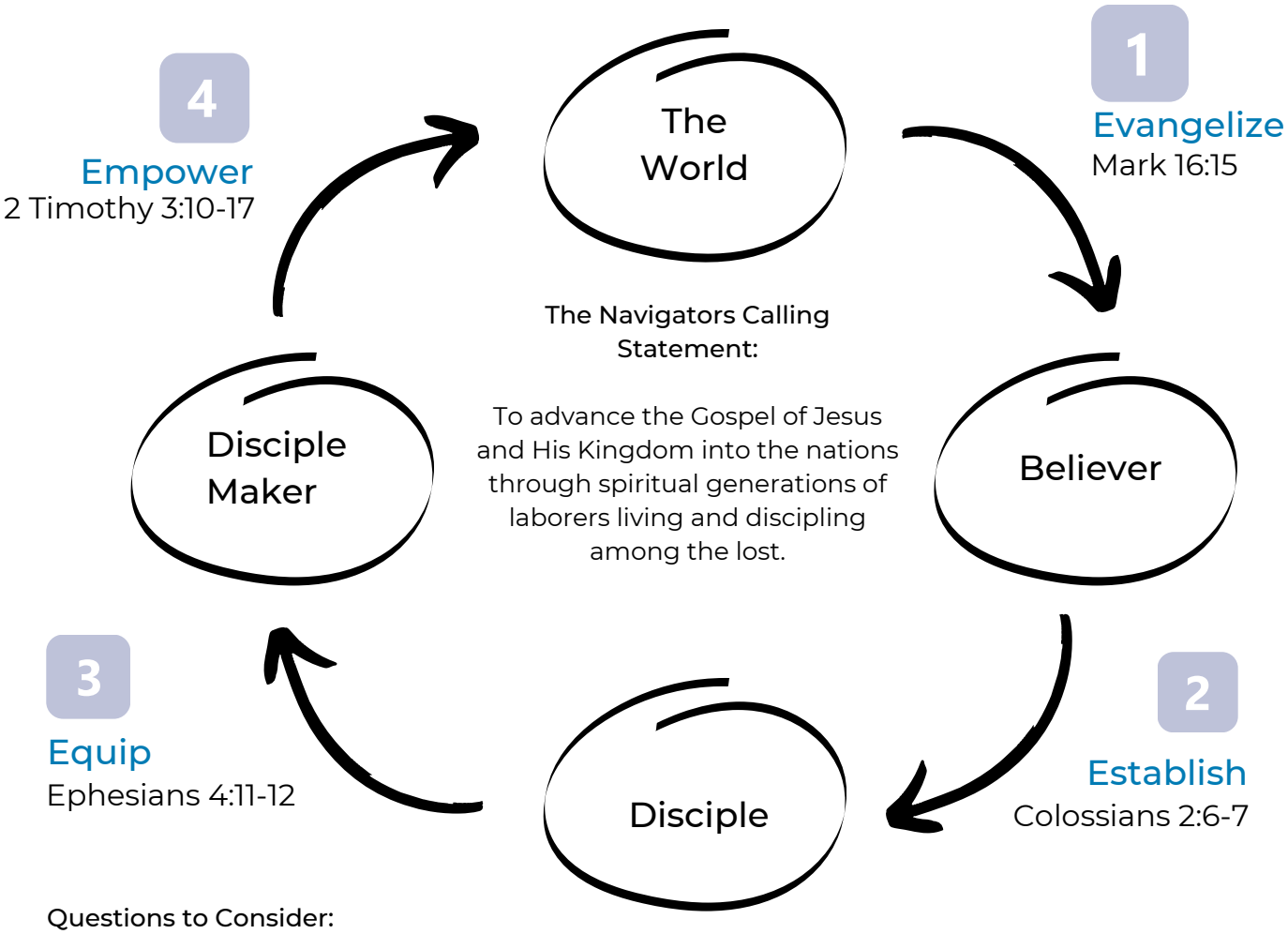
1. What often feels like the most pressing need of the hour for you as you join in God's work?
2. Thinking of your personal ministry, what things are you most tempted to rely on for the advancement of the Gospel?
3. How does this article change your understanding of how God sees the need of the hour?
4. What would it look like for you to join God in meeting this need of the hour?
5. What would it cost you?
6. What can you ask God to do in and through you this year to help meet the need of the hour?
7. We all need allies in this glorious mission. Who will you share your promises with? How will you hold each other accountable to continue to regularly pray for this?

Equip



THE DISCIPLESHIP PROCESS

Spend time reading the verses and discussing the discipleship process shown below. The purpose of this exercise is to gain a greater picture of the discipleship process, and be able to assess where an individual may be in order to best help them grow as a disciple maker! Begin by reviewing the Great Commission in Matthew 28:18-20.



Questions to Consider:

- Where are you in this process? Why would you say so?
- What is one thing you could do to grow in the stage you're in?
- What would be the result of skipping a stage in this process?
- Is there someone God is asking you to begin to disciple? Where would you say they are on this process?

Equip

JESUS AND DISCIPLESHIP

Spend time reading and making observations about the following passages. After you have discussed the passages, read through the disciplemaking principles below.

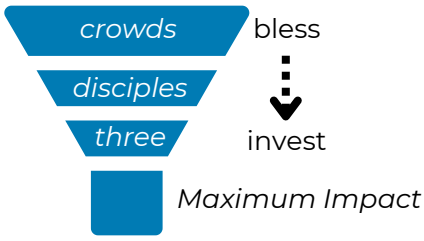
Matthew 9:35-38: *Who did Jesus minister to? What did Jesus pray for?*
And Jesus went throughout all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every affliction. When he saw the crowds, he had compassion for them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd. Then he said to his disciples, "The harvest is plentiful, but the laborers are few; therefore pray earnestly to the Lord of the harvest to send out laborers into his harvest."

Luke 6:12-16: *From whom did Jesus call his disciples? What preceded this event?*
In these days he went out to the mountain to pray, and all night he continued in prayer to God. And when day came, he called his disciples and chose from them twelve, whom he named apostles: Simon, whom he named Peter, and Andrew his brother, and James and John, and Philip, and Bartholomew, and Matthew, and Thomas, and James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon who was called the Zealot, and Judas the son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.

Matthew 17:1-2: *Who did Jesus bring with him? Can you think of any other times Jesus singled out these three disciples?*
And after six days Jesus took with him Peter and James, and John his brother, and led them up a high mountain by themselves. And he was transfigured before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his clothes became white as light.

Disciple Making Principles:

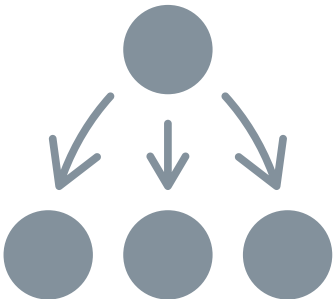
1. Jesus ministered to the crowds (Matthew 9:35-38, Luke 6:17, etc)
2. Jesus chose twelve to be with Him (Luke 6:12-16, Matthew 10:1-4, Mark 3:13-19)
3. Jesus invested heavily in the three (Matthew 17:1-2, Mark 5:37, Mark 14:33)



Principles Applied:

1. Just as Jesus spent disproportionate time with the three, so we need to spend lots of time with a few in order to help others become disciple makers.
2. Spend time with someone before jumping into a discipleship relationship with them -- get to know them without committing to anything. If you are still unsure, agree to spend 4 to 6 weeks meeting with them.
3. Pray for men and women who are FAT -- Faithful, Available and Teachable.
4. When you are ready to begin a discipleship relationship with someone you may find the following steps helpful:
   - Spend time **sharing your story** and how discipleship benefited you.
   - **Affirm** what you see in them.
   - **Cast vision** and **set expectations** for the time so that it does not simply become a glorified friendship.
   - Clearly **invite** them to be discipled by you.
   - **Establish** a time and place to meet right there!

Equip



DISCIPLESHIP 101

WHAT is Discipleship

The Greek word- mathētés translates into English as – 'disciple' or 'learner' or 'pupil'. The word disciple itself typically has two aspects to it: the relationship of a student to a teacher, and the notion of following along behind someone. First and foremost, our discipleship is to Jesus Christ, a relationship of being with him and following him (Matt 16:24-25).

In the words of John Stott: "At its simplest, Christ's call was 'Follow me.' He asked men and women for their personal allegiance. He invited them to learn from him, to obey his words and to identify themselves with his cause". In this discipleship process we are being 'transformed' so that we will eventually be 'conformed' to his likeness (Rom 8:29, 2 Cor 3:18).

The verb form 'to disciple', describes the process by which we encourage another person to be such a follower of Jesus; it means the methods we may employ to help that person to grow as a 'learner 'of Christ, to grow towards full maturity in Christ, so they may also in turn disciple someone else (i.e. that they too may become a 'disciple maker').

By using the word 'discipling', Al Stewart best describes this activity as – "more than simply evangelizing unbelievers, discipling is defined as: prayerfully and faithfully building people up until they are mature followers of the Lord Jesus (Col 1:28). Discipling is moving people forward in their knowledge of God; in their commitment to Christ; and in their commitment to serving others". In this regard, true discipleship and disciple making must rightly be understood as a process not a program.

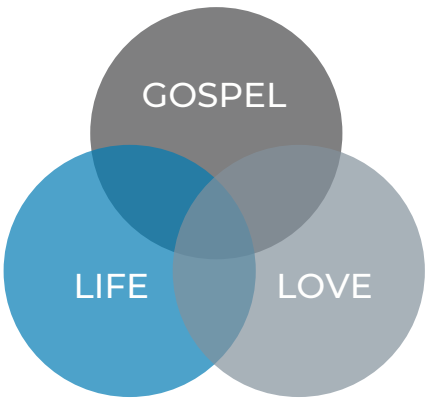
HOW do we Disciple

Because we loved you so much, we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well. - 1 Thessalonians 2:8

Discipleship involves *relationship!* It is not systematic or achieved through programs, but *life to life*. First Thessalonians 2:8 describes three areas necessary for authentic discipleship: **Life**, **Love**, and **the Gospel**.

Spend time considering what discipleship would be like if it excluded one of these three areas:

No sharing of **life** = Meaningless
No affection (**love**) of the other = Mechanical
No focus on the **Gospel** = Mentorship



DISCIPLESHIP 101

WHAT are we building

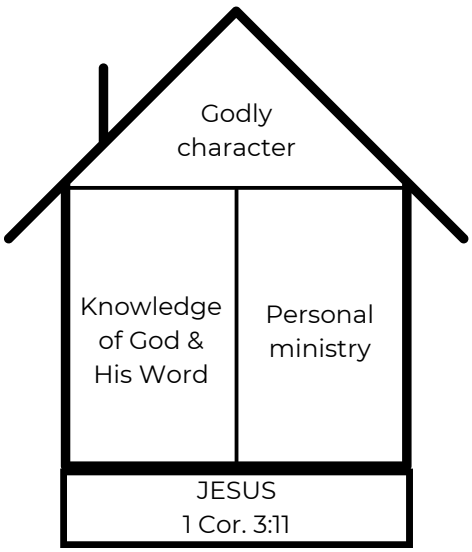
Read 1 Corinthians 3:5-11 and spend time discussing the passage.

- What is the foundation?
- Do all buildings stand the test of time?
- What might make some structures last and others burn up?

Read Romans 15:14, listed below. What is Paul desiring would be established in the life of the believer?

*I myself am convinced, my brothers and sisters, that you yourselves are **full of goodness**, **filled with knowledge** and **competent to instruct one another**.*

A helpful illustration is a house. The foundation is Christ (1 Cor 3:11). In the verse above, Paul longs to see them be filled with knowledge of God and His Word, and able to instruct one another by understanding how to reproduce their life in another (personal ministry). This is held together by being full of goodness, which is another way to say having exemplary character.



There are many ways to disciple another. Scripture does not give us a detailed roadmap! But it does list important principles for the process.

PRINCIPLES for Discipleship

Just as Jesus spent signifiant amounts of time with Peter, James and John, so we must spend disproportional amounts of time with a few to make the greatest impact.

Paul reiterates this in 2 Timothy 2:2 when he stresses to Timothy that he is to invest in “reliable” men and women. A helpful acronym is whether they are **FAT** individuals: **Faithful, Available, and Teachable.**

Discipleship involves caring for the whole person! Consider the relationships below and how they relate to discipleship:

- **Counselor** -- While discipleship involves caring for the needs of another, it is more than simple addressing specific needs in their life! Discipleship involves being a **builder** in the life of another, not simply a **doctor** to address the current need.
- **Friend** -- Hopefully a friendship is developed between you and who you are discipling! But discipleship involves more than simply being friends; it’s also helping to point them to Jesus and have an **intentional plan** to do so!
- **Mentor** -- It is difficult, if not impossible, to lead somewhere you have not gone yourself. A mentorship is where one person passes along their wisdom and expertise to another. While this may be a part of discipleship, discipleship differs from mentorship in that you are ultimately taking them to the **feet of Jesus** to learn together from God Himself, **guided by the Holy Spirit** in each of your lives!

Application: List the names of 1-3 people you might want to begin a discipleship relationship with, and begin praying God would open the door to invest in their life in this way!

Equip

MASTER BUILDER: THE WHEEL

According to the grace of God given to me, like a skilled master builder I laid a foundation, and someone else is building upon it. Let each one take care how he builds upon it.
1 Corinthians 3:10

We want to be **skilled master builders**, and build wisely into the lives of those we disciple! One of the best tools to assess where someone needs to grow is **the Wheel**. Below is a helpful plan for how to walk through the Wheel with someone you are discipling!

The Wheel

Begin with the Word to help anchor the time in Scripture.

Look up Colossians 2:6-7 and read it together. Ask "What does it mean to 'walk in Him'?"

Explain that spiritual disciplines are the means of experiencing God's grace in our lives. Share a personal example of how a spiritual discipline has helped you experience the grace of God more fully in your own life.

Draw out the wheel while explaining the hub, spokes and rim:

- All of life is found in knowing Jesus and abiding in Him [*draw Jesus as the center*].
- We communicate with God through prayer and spending time reading God's Word [*draw the vertical spokes: prayer and the Word*].
- As we interact with others, we seek to love those around us through encouraging and serving the body of Christ, and helping those who don't yet know Christ be introduced to Him [*draw the horizontal spokes: fellowship and evangelism]*.
- Our inner life reflects our outer reality, where the "rubber meets the road." Through living a life obedient to Jesus, we show the world our inner devotion to Him [*draw the rim of the wheel and write "obedience to Christ" in the rim]*.

Look up verses that talk about the center, each of the spokes, and the rim using the A-Pack of the TMS (pg 22) and discuss them together.

***For an application**, ask them to draw out the Wheel as it would look in their own life, with the lengths of the spoke showing how that spiritual discipline is reflected in their own life. Share what yours might look like. Ask if they would like to begin to grow in some of these areas together, and make a plan to meet next week to dive deeper into each topic.*

The **Establish** section of this binder is designed with tools to help someone grow in each of these areas! Next time you and your disciple meet, begin in the **Establish** section working through areas of the Wheel you both would like to grow in!

Equip

DISCIPLESHIP BLUEPRINT

Before beginning any large project it is important to keep the end in mind. No builder of a house begins building without consulting a blueprint! Similarly, it is important to keep the end in mind when discipling someone. Once you have reviewed "Discipleship 101," use this plan to help create blueprints for your discipleship time. An example is provided, with a blank copy accessible via QR code.

A helpful plan for each meeting time involves sharing **life**, the **Word**, **mission**, and **prayer** (expanded plan on pg 3). Look up the verses below as you examine those areas.

1. LIFE - *1 Thess. 2:8* 2. WORD - *Jn. 15:4-5* 3. MISSION - *Col. 1:28-29* 4. PRAYER - *Jn. 15:16*

NAME: JOE STUDENT YEAR: FRESHMAN

TOP THREE GOALS (TANGIBLE OUTCOMES) FOR THIS UPCOMING YEAR

1. Enjoy time spent in the Word each day.
2. Share the Gospel with one of their friends during this year
3. Understand God's desire for holiness, and reflect that conviction in their dating relationship, being accountable to one close friend.

	Theme	Next Steps		Theme	Next Steps
Aug	Establish	Show how to have quiet time sandwich.	Jan	Obedience	Ask to participate in a WITL study with their friend.
S	The Word	Have a Quiet Time together, show how to memorize scripture.	F	Evangelism	Invite to participate in IBD. Practice sharing the Three Circles.
O	Christ the Center	MHCH. Ask how their quiet times are going. Invite to have an extended time together.	M	Evangelism	Share the Three Circles with someone on their prayer map.
N	Nations	Begin praying for the Nations together. Create prayer map	A	Prayer	Pray for lost friends; share the Gospel with anyone who has not heard.
D	Send	Have a QT every day over break. Discuss loving family well.	M-J		

Equip

BUILDING WELL:
Values over Behaviors

PART I: Overview of Building Well
Healthy discipleship is building well into the lives of others. Spend some time reading 1 Corinthians 3:4-17 and make note of what Paul says about: **the builder, the building,** and **the building process.**

In verses 10-15 Paul makes it clear that what we build into ourselves and others matters, because fire will test the materials. Therefore we want to be building with values, not just behaviors or knowledge.

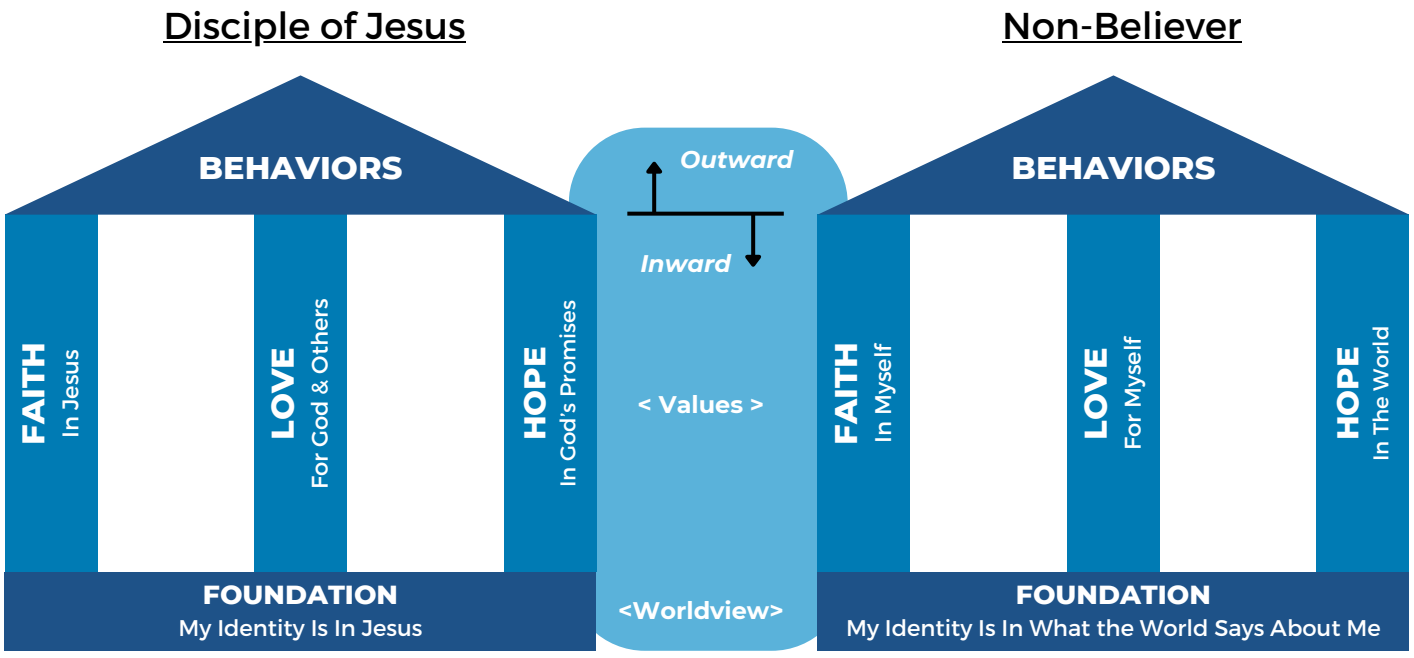
- What potential "fires" will we face in life?
- How would these two lives be different in the "fires": the one primarily built on values, and the other on behaviors and/or knowledge?

The important values repeated over and over in Paul's epistles are **faith**, **hope**, and **love**. These materials, rooted in a foundation of Jesus, are the ones that will last and that we want to be building into ourselves and others.

And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love.
(1 Corinthians 13:13)

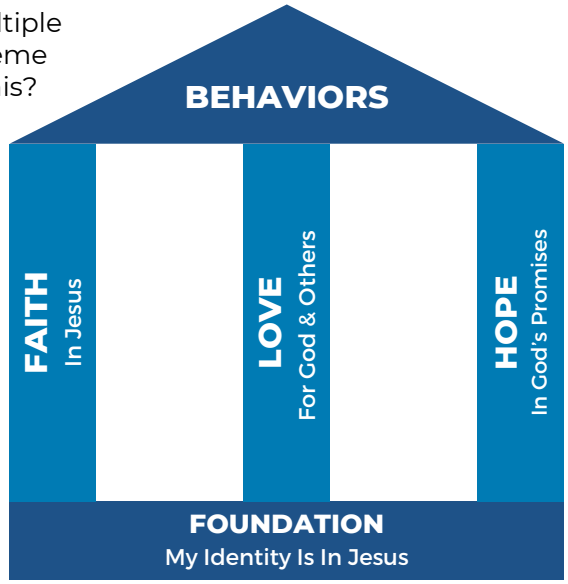
These principles are depicted by the building illustrations below, differentiating between a disciple of Jesus and a non-believer. Considering the two illustrations:

- Our Worldview (Identity) dictates our Values and our Values will dictate our Behaviors. How have you seen this to be true?
- What are the differences between the two buildings when lived out in daily life?
- Is there an area that you personally want to grow?



BUILDING WELL

Parts II-VI of this plan dive more deeply into the various elements of the building illustration. They can be done over the course of multiple meetings, but for each: (1) How does this connect to the main theme of building well? (2) How could you help someone else grow in this?



PART II: Foundation of Jesus
Read Matthew 7:24-27
- Why is it important to have a foundation on Jesus?

From John 1:1-18 and Colossians 1:13-23:
- List out the truths of Jesus
- Why is He a good foundation for our lives?
- What is our identity in light of His?

Apply: Choose a truth of Jesus that is hard to believe. Memorize and meditate on a corresponding verse, asking Jesus to help you believe it is true.

PART III: Love
Read 1 John 4:7-21:
- How is God's love described?
- How are we called to love in light of His love?

Listen to "*Love and the Practical Graces*" sermon by Timothy Keller *(can be found on YouTube.)*
- What does it look like to grow in love?

Apply: Choose one practical step to love God or someone else this week. Ask someone to join you!

PART IV: Faith
How would you define faith? List out 5-10 verses that talk about faith and read them together.
Read Hebrews 11:1-16 (Hall of Faith)
- Based on this, what marks a life of faith?

Apply: Choose a spiritual discipline you enjoy. How has it helped you grow in faith? Practice sharing it through the lens of growing in faith!

PART V: Hope
Read Romans 8:18-30
- Make observations about hope
- What are we hoping for and in?

Hebrews 6:19 calls hope "*an anchor for the soul*"
- Why is hope important? What anchors your soul?

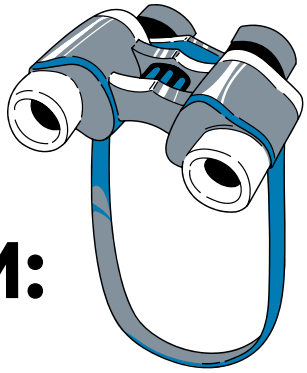
Apply: Choose a promise of God to hope for. Is there someone else who needs to hear this too?

PART VI: Persevering in Love, Faith, and Hope
Read Hebrews 10:19-25
- What does it say about...
  - Foundation in Christ (19-22)?
  - Love (24-25)?
  - Faith (22)?
  - Hope (23)?
- Why is perseverance needed to live these out?

Summarize what you've learned in Parts I-VI in 1-3 sentences. How should this impact disciple making?
Apply: What would your life look like in 5, 10, 20 years if you persevered in each of thee areas? What is one choice you can make today to help you persevere for a lifetime?

**Optional Study: Read each of the epistles and note the uses of faith, hope, and love (highlight, box, circle, etc). Further study the passages that use all three: (1) What do you learn about each of them? (2) How do they interconnect? (3) What context are they being used in?*

Equip



RELATIONAL EVANGELISM: P.A.L.S.

When Jesus called his disciples, it was not an invitation to "do" evangelism, but to "be" evangelists; in fact all areas of their lives would change to walk the same path as their teacher.

"And He said to them, "Follow Me [as My disciples, accepting Me as your Master and Teacher and walking the same path of life that I walk], and I will make you fishers of men." Matthew 4:19 [AMP]

Although the word "evangelism" can be intimidating, when we examine Jesus' life, it is as simple as obeying the Father courageously in the regular rhythms of life.

Here are 4 rhythms to live out of our identity as children while we courageously and lovingly live out our calling as evangelists.

PURSUE HOLINESS

Heb. 12:14, Matt. 5:14-16

- Be someone who enjoys Jesus and lives out of the "freedom" of their design (who we are AND who we pursue to be)
- The people around us need us to be more holy than relevant

ACTIVE PRAYER LIST

Matt. 9:36-38, Jn. 15:7

- Be someone who aligns their heart with Jesus regularly and believes him by faith
- Pray Promises, Pray for Souls

LOOK FOR OPPORTUNITIES

Eph. 2:10, Jn. 4:34-38

- See ourselves as Christ's masterpieces, ambassadors of the good news we have received, and that we were created for good things prepared beforehand

SALTY CONVERSATIONS

Col. 4:5-6, Matt. 10:16

- Be someone who is curious like Jesus and ask courageously
- Remember FORT (Family, Occupation, Recreation, Testimony)

Equip

GOSPEL FLUENCY

What makes someone fluent in a language? How about fluent in the gospel?

How natural is it for your to relate the gospel to your own day-to-day life? Why?

A basic rule of communication is that we are to communicate with others in a way *they* best understand. When sharing the gospel, this often requires us to step out of our natural way of relating in order to meet someone else where they currently are in their understanding of the gospel, rather than where *we* might be in our understanding, or how *we* would like to be communicated with.

Consider the definitions and tool below. Fill out the practice example, then complete an example of your own from an encounter you had this past week!

EXPERIENCE: A specific event or feeling you've had recently. Could span a moment or months.

CONCEPT/WORD: An idea or theme from the gospel / God's Word that is especially good news to you right now in response to that experience. This helps anchor our thinking and experience and narrows it into something specific that can be shared. We grow to interpret our lives through the gospel, not the other way around.

VERSE: Ground that concept/word in the Scriptures by relating it to a verse that God has used in your life (or explains the concept/word well). This also helps subtly introduce God's Word and reveals our daily dependence on it. Hearing you quote Scripture becomes normal to your non-believing friends.

QUESTION: Open up the conversation to your friend or community. This gives the listener a chance to respond and gives you an easy way to discuss the Word.

CONCEPTS FOUND IN THE GOSPEL:

Grace, peace, love, hope, faith, forgiveness, freedom, healing, restoration, reconciliation, redemption, purification, belonging, intimacy, joy, newness, fully known, reborn, understood, tenderness, Father, fullness, complete, pursuit, family, fellowship (with God and people), security, purpose

EXAMPLE: Recently when I've been feeling down on myself for "not doing enough," whether that be in work or pursuing friends while I've been home for Christmas time. God has been reminding me of how gentle he is to me even though I'm weak and inconsistent. There's a cool verse in the Bible that talks about how Jesus "sympathizes with our weaknesses" because he experienced the same trials and temptations as us when he lived on earth. The next verse says that we should draw near to God with confidence so that we can receive mercy and grace when we're in need. So, I've been thanking God that he understands why I'm frustrated and even more so that he wants me to go to him for help. Do you feel like Jesus understands you? / Would you want to see those verses I was talking about? What do you think about them?

EXPERIENCE	CONCEPT/WORD	VERSE	QUESTION
Feeling forgotten by friends, but remembering that God seeks me out constantly	God's pursuit	Isaiah 62:12 "...you shall be called Sought Out, a City Not Forsaken"	Do you think God is pursuing you? /Do you want to see that verse I was talking about?

EXTENDED TIME WITH THE FATHER

In a marriage, it is important to prioritize healthy rhythms in the midst of the busyness of life. These often include a daily touch point, a weekly date night, and a monthly/quarterly extended time together.

So in our union with Christ, it is important to develop healthy rhythms in the midst of the noise around us to hear from our savior. In addition to daily time with God, a helpful rhythm is an extended time away together.

And he said to them, "Come away by yourselves to a desolate place and rest a while." For many were coming and going, and they had no leisure even to eat.
Mark 6:31

Consider the verse above. To what were the disciples invited into? What were they invited away from?

WHAT is an extended time with the Father

There is no right way to have an extended time away with the Father, nor set amount of time required. For some this may mean stretching yourself to spend two hours with God. For others it might look like a morning, an entire day, or a weekend.

Lorne Sanny, former president of The Navigators, once said:
"The result of your day in prayer should be answers to the two questions Paul asked the Lord on the Damascus road (Acts 22:6-10). Paul's first question was, 'Who are you, Lord?' The Lord replied, 'I am Jesus.' You will be seeking to know Him, to find out who He is. The second question Paul asked was, 'What shall I do, Lord?' and the Lord answered him specifically. This should be answered or reconfirmed for you in that part of the day when you unhurriedly seek His will for you."

HOW to spend an extended time with the Father

Pastor and teacher John Mark Comer once remarked that our lives can feel like water in a pitcher, sloshing around when moved. Once the pitcher is placed steady on a table it will take the water some time to settle. This is often true of our lives in an ever more hurried culture.

Begin your time settling your heart. This may involve going for a walk, journaling, praying (silently, out loud as you walk, or with a friend), singing hymns or reflecting on a Psalm. The goal of this time is to answer the question: How am I doing?

After some time, it will likely be helpful to go to Scripture. Consider reading through an entire epistle, a section of scripture, or reviewing verses you have found meaningful. Prayerfully consider who the Lord is and what He might have to say to you through the time.

EXTENDED TIME WITH THE FATHER

Everyone is different. Some may prefer a plan, others prefer the freedom to approach the Word unhurried. Some may like to sing or reflect who God is through nature, others may want to spend time studying in-depth a passage of scripture. Whatever the case, keep the focus of the time on knowing God and hearing from Him.

Use the QR code if you're looking for a framework to use.

BEST PRACTICES for spending extended time with the Father.

- **TIMING:** This time never simply "appears" - it must be intentionally created and rigorously guarded. Consider scheduling this with a like-minded friend so you both can stay accountable.

- **RHYTHMS:** While this practice may be particularly helpful when facing an important decision, it is helpful to develop this discipline as a regular rhythm in our lives! Consider blocking out time weekly or monthly. Many have found it helpful to spend a weekend away with the Lord annually. Consider fasting during this time to remember how the Lord sustains you!

- **DISTRACTIONS:** It is only natural for distractions to arise! Keep a piece of paper close by to write down any tasks that come to mind that you might need to attend to later. Resist the temptation to work on something that comes up. Write it down and move on, knowing you can address it later. Consider silencing or even turning off your phone and electronics for this time.

- **WHAT TO TAKE:** Consider bringing noise canceling headphones, a pen and your journal, your Bible, any sermon or workshop notes you would like to review, verses you have been memorizing or meditating on, and possibly a devotional book. It may be helpful to bring old journals to review during this time.

- **STAY ALERT:** Be sure to get a good night sleep before setting out on this time. If spending all day or multiple days with the Lord, take breaks every so often to go for a walk, or go somewhere you can talk out loud. Give variety in what you do -- pray, journal, spend time in Scripture, etc.

- **KEEP THE MAIN THING THE MAIN THING:** The purpose of a date with a loved one is not to try out a new restaurant or see the movie you've been wanting to see; it is to spend time together with the someone you love. So it is with the Lord during this time. The primary goal is to spend time with the Father. Enjoy hearing from Him what He longs to say to you!

He says, "Be still, and know that I am God; I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth."
Psalm 46:10

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PRAYING THE PROMISES: PLEADING WITH GOD

Be strong and courageous. In times of distress turn to God in prayer and ask Him to fulfill His promises to His people. To see the following principles applied, read Daniel 9:1-19.

ATTITUDE OF HUMILITY AND EXPECTANCY

We come with a twofold attitude of both abject humility and courageous expectancy. We don't dictate to God, even when claiming His promises. But we do come boldly, reverentially before His throne.

ACKNOWLEDGE AND CONFESS SIN

We come before God acknowledging our sinfulness and confessing our sins as the Holy Spirit brings them to remembrance. We must not deceive ourselves into thinking that the Lord will honor our requests if we harbor unconfessed sin in our lives or if we are living in a condition of disobedience to His revealed will in the Bible.

BRING SPECIFIC CONCERNS AND DETAILS TO GOD

It is not that the omniscient Lord needs more information; rather in doing this, our thoughts clarify, and the Lord can help us better understand and gain perspective on our current situation.

FOCUS ON GOD'S CHARACTER

It is good to remind the Lord of certain related character qualities, not only pleading that He act in keeping with His character, but also asking Him to build these into our lives during this testing of our faith.

BASE OUR REQUESTS ON THE PROMISES IN GOD'S WORD

Though we do make specific requests, we again must yield to the Lord the right to answer in His way and in His time. He alone can see all things; He knows what circumstances and timing are best for us. Having a demanding spirit regarding either the means or the time of God's answer is a sign of spiritual immaturity.

PRAYING THE PROMISES: PLEADING WITH GOD

PROMISES TO DEPEND ON FROM GOD'S WORD REGARDING HIS LOVE AND CARE FOR YOU.

PSALM 103:17
But from everlasting to everlasting the Lord's love is with those who fear him, and his righteousness with their children's children.

NAHUM 1:7
The Lord is good, a refuge in times of trouble. He cares for those who trust in him.

MATTHEW 6:31-33
So do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.

MATTHEW 10:29-31
Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father's care. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So don't be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.

JOHN 14:21
Whoever has my commands and keeps them is the one who loves me. The one who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I too will love them and show myself to them.

JOHN 15:9,10
As the Father has loved me, so have I loved you. Now remain in my love. If you keep my commands, you will remain in my love, just as I have kept my Father's commands and remain in his love.

ROMANS 8:32
He who did not spare his own Son, but gave him up for us all—how will he not also, along with him, graciously give us all things?

1 PETER 5:7
Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you.

For a list of promises related to specific topics, scan the QR code

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/pleading
Adapted from Praying Over God's Promises, *by Tom Yeakley, used with permission of NavPress.*

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YOUR PLACE IN MISSIONS

A Concise World Vision Bible Study

PART I: Meditate on the following verses and list one fresh insight from each on God's heart for all nations. Then note 1-2 overall themes that stand out to you.

- Genesis 12:1-3
- Genesis 22:15-18
- 2 Samuel 14:14
- Isaiah 43:3-7
- Isaiah 49:6
- Isaiah 60:22
- Matthew 9:35-38
- Matthew 28:18-20
- Mark 16:15
- Luke 19:10
- Luke 24:44-48
- John 4:35
- John 20:21-23
- Acts 1:8
- Revelation 7:9-10

PART II: Read Isaiah 6, and note God giving Isaiah a vision of His glory, a vision of Isaiah's brokenness, and a vision of the world's need.

A. Do you think all 3 visions are critical for missions? Why? And why might there be significance to their occurring in this sequence?

B. Why do you think God asks for volunteers after the second vision, instead of after the first or third?

PART III: What is the warning for going into missions in Jeremiah 12:5?

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Read through each of the following five traits, making observations about how you can live these out in your context and community.

5 Marks of a **DISCIPLEMAKER**

1 JESUS

A passion to know, love and become like Christ

Philippians 3:8-10

Followers of Christ with a passion to know and love Jesus. As disciplemakers and laborers in the harvest, they are purposeful to nurture and deepen their intimacy with Him. Life and ministry overflows from time alone with Jesus. The focus is developing personal intimacy with Jesus. It's more than just knowing about God. It's knowing Him and walking deeply with Him.

2 THE WORD

Knows and lives from the Scriptures

2 Timothy 3:16-17

A disciplemaker is one who can handle accurately the Word of God. They know how to read it, study it, talk about it and pass it on to others. A disciplemaker understands the truth and sufficiency of the Word for the whole of life.

3 COMMUNITY

Pursuing Biblical community

Hebrews 10:24-25

The Lord designed us to walk with Him in community with others. A disciplemaker will be intentional to seek, pursue and create a local community of believers to spur each other toward love and good deeds. Biblical community includes family as well as extended communities of followers of Christ. Biblical community also draws those without Christ to the Lord (John 13:33-34).

4 THE LOST

Lives among those who do not know or follow Christ

I Thessalonians 2:8

A disciplemaker will be among those who are without Christ. They will be purposeful to love, serve and help them know and understand the Gospel. They are marked by strong commitment to the Great Commission and a strong compassion for the brokenness of those without Christ. Disciplemakers proclaim and affirm the Gospel with both their words and their lives.

5 SPIRITUAL GENERATIONS

Advancing the Gospel through spiritual generations

2 Timothy 2:2

A disciplemaker is personally involved with helping others move closer to Christ as Savior and Lord. Disciplemakers meet one on one to help non-believers understand who Christ claims to be, and to establish young believers in their faith. A disciplemaker may lead groups of others in studying and applying the Word. Anything that helps others move closer to Christ is discipleship. A disciplemaker helps others catch a vision for investing their lives in others so that others will disciple more to do the same... towards spiritual generations.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/disciplemaker

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MANY ASPIRE, FEW ATTAIN

"Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction, and many enter through it. But small is the gate and narrow the road that leads to life, and only a few find it."
Matthew 7:13-14

Jesus invites all to lay down their lives, pick up their cross, and follow Him. Sadly, experience shows that while His invitation is broad, only a few finish well.

Paul had the end in mind when he wrote in 2 Timothy 4:7-8 -- *I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day—and not only to me, but also to all who have longed for his appearing.*

David sought this principle by aiming to keep the main thing the main thing, as reflected in Psalm 27:4 -- *One thing I ask from the Lord, this only do I seek: that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life, to gaze on the beauty of the Lord and to seek him in his temple.*

Ezra similarly grasped this principle in Ezra 7:10 -- *For Ezra had set his heart to study the law of The Lord, and to do it and to teach his statues and rules in Israel*. He sought to know God first for himself, and only then to teach it to others.

In 1975, Walt Henrichsen wrote a timeless article called "Many Aspire, Few Attain." Spend time reading through the article and consider the questions below:

Discussion Questions

- What impacted you most from the article?
- Is there one or two of the points that you find yourself most susceptible to? What will you do about that?
- Who will you invite to be in the inside of your life and journey with you?
- What is one application you will make as a result of reading this article?

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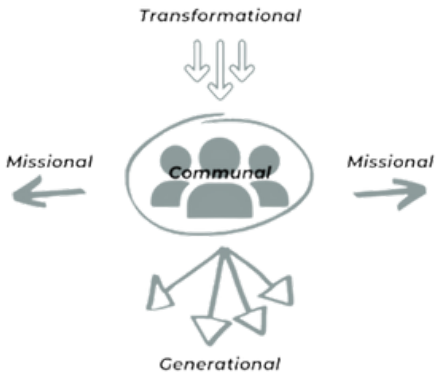

DISCIPLEMAKING COMMUNITIES

Western cultures can often view the Bible through an individualistic lens, whereas other cultures gravitate towards a communal lens. In English, there is no good word that expresses the plural form of "you." Yet, "all of you" is often a more accurate reading of many of Paul's instructions to the early churches in the Epistles.

READ

Spend time reading 1 Thessalonians 1:2-10 in the "you'all" version. As you read, consider the question: What separates a group of friends from an intentional, disciplemaking community?

"2We thank God always for all y'all, mentioning y'all in our prayers, 3constantly remembering before our God and Father y'all's work of faith, labor of love, and perseverance of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ. 4We know, siblings beloved by God, that y'all are chosen, 5and that our gospel came to y'all not in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Spirit, and with deep conviction. Y'all saw how we lived among y'all for your* sake. 6Y'all became imitators of us and of the Lord, having received the word with the joy of the Holy Spirit despite deep oppression.

7As a result y'all became an example to all the believers in Macedonia and in Achaia. 8For the word of the Lord has reverberated out from y'all, not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but y'all's faith in God has spread everywhere. We don't even need to say anything, 9for the people themselves are reporting what kind of reception we had with y'all, and how y'all turned to God from idols to serve a living and true God, 10and to wait for His Son from heaven, whom he raised from the dead: Jesus, who delivers us from the wrath to come."

OBSERVE

Disciplemaking Communities (DMCs) can manifest themselves in a variety of contexts, but all share four primary categories (below). Consider the questions below as you think back through 1 Thess 1:2-10.

- Communal: Are they friends? How are the 'One Another's' of Scripture being lived out?
- Transformational: Is the Gospel transforming lives of individuals? Are there ways community could help spur this transformation on?
- Missional: Are friends being reached with the Gospel? Do individuals in the DMC know where their areas of influence exist? Are there shared areas of influence among those in the DMC that can be reached together?
- Generational: Is there the intention of reaching the next generation? How is the next generation included in this DMC? How will this DMC be used to launch teams to help future generations?

PERSONALIZE & APPLY

Are there communities you are currently a part of (insider) that could become Disciplemaking Communities? What are some specific next steps you could take?

Are there situations where you function as either someone who comes alongside another to help them minister, or an area in your life where you are directly ministering among others? How might these areas benefit from what you've observed about DMCs? What is one step you could take to help this area function as an intentional disciplemaking community?

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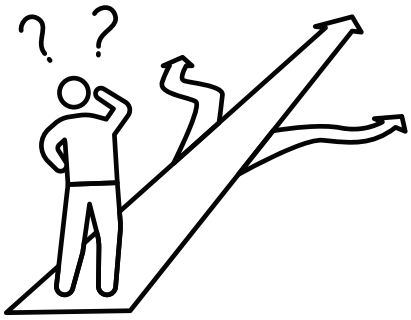


DECISION-MAKING
DISCERNING GOD'S WILL AND CALLING

SURRENDER TO DOING GOD's WILL - the key to any decision

Because God is God, He will have no trouble in communicating to us what He wants us to do. Our problem is doing God's will, not knowing God's will! We must be willing to do whatever He desires for us, before He will let us know His plan for us. This can be frightening, but if we really know God and His love, we will also trust Him that He will only give us good things.
John 7:17; Romans 12:1-2; Jeremiah 29:11; Matthew 7:9-11

5 MEANS TO DISCERNING GOD'S WILL

1. The Word of God - Psalm 119:105; Proverbs 6:22-23
Obviously, if something is contrary to a direct teaching in Scripture, it is not the will of God [i.e. marrying a non-Christian (2 Corinthians 6:14)]. But God can also speak to us concerning our specific situations from the bible. You will know in your heart that this is God's promise to you concerning your decision.

2. Personal Peace When We Pray - Philippians 4:6-7; Psalm143:8,10; Isaiah 30:21
Though you may not have all the answers yet, you will have a deep peace of heart, a rest in your heart, knowing that this is from God. The Holy Spirit will confirm in your heart that this is the way, even if it involves hardship or sadness.

3. Counsel From Mature Believers - Proverbs 15:22; 13:20; 19:20
Objective counsel from mature believers will be used to give perspective and direction. It is hard to get counsel from someone who does not have hidden motives. Finding the right counselors who know us, want our best and God's best is a challenge, but God will send them along. Your parents are some of the best counselors you will find. Notice that it is the abundance of counselors that gives wisdom. Most people will just tell you what you want to hear, especially your friends, because they don't want to jeopardize the friendship.

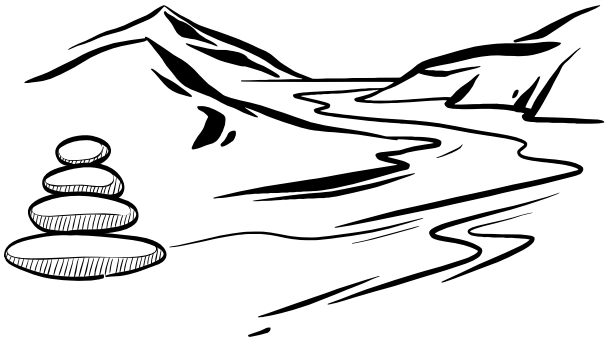
4. Wise Thinking - 1 Peter 1:13; Proverbs 3:5-6
God gave you a lot of leading when He gave you a brain. Use a plus/minus system to think through the good and bad points of any decision. The Scriptures teach us not to lean on our own understanding, but they don't say to not use our own understanding! Just don't depend on it only.

5. Providential Circumstances - Revelation 3:7-8; Acts 16:6-9
God will open doors to guide us. He will close doors to lead us to other open doors. He will provide opportunities.

**The more of the five things that we see agreeing, pointing in the same direction, the more certain we can be that this is God's will. If one or two agree, but the others don't, we have two possibilities. It may be God's will, but the wrong timing. Or, it may not be God's will. In either case, it's best to wait; time will clarify. Immaturity will press ahead when things are not clear and pay a big price! (Proverbs 19:2)

GOD IS SOVEREIGN

Remember, the foundation is surrendering to doing God's will. We can deceive ourselves. We can find verses to justify just about anything. We can "have peace" about a lot of things. Satan can open doors for us also. However, also remember this: God being God, He will not allow circumstances, governments, organizations, or anyone with authority over us to hinder His plan for us. In fact, He uses them to direct us to His plan for us (see Joseph in Genesis 50:20).



MEMORIAL STONES

Throughout scripture God calls His people to create memorial stones or *"ebenezers"* to remind themselves of His character and deeds, so that they can continue to persevere in loving and following Him. We also want to be people of remembrance and perseverance. Read the following verses and make observations:

Deuteronomy 6:1-12 **[The Importance of Remembering]**

- Why is it important to remember the Lord and His deeds?
- How are people called to remember?

Joshua 4:1-9, 19-24 **[An Example of a Memorial Stone]**

- Why was the memorial significant? What did it teach them about God?

Judges 2:10-13 **[Warning Against Forgetting]**

- What was the result of Israel forgetting the Lord?

How has God been revealing Himself and developing you?

Work through the following steps to help identify some of your own memorial stones and life lessons.

Step 1 - Identifying Your Memorial Stones

Identify both positive and negative memorial stones—people, circumstances, and events that God has used to shape your life. Consider, but do not limit yourself to, some of the following categories:

Crisis/Losses/Pain	Parents, significant relatives
Defeats/Failure	Conflicts
Victories	Successes/Blessings
Adverse circumstances	Meaningful scripture, promises
Friends, mentors	Major decisions

Be sure to spend time in prayer. Ask God to reveal to you elements of your life that could establish patterns as to how He has developed you and/or taught you about Himself.

Step 2 - Reflecting on Life Lessons

Pray and ask God for insight into what He might have been saying to you or teaching you. Feel the freedom to work on this over the course of a set period of time, not just in one sitting.

1. Referring to your timeline, identify 3-5 key memorial stones. Focus on a person, event, or circumstance, not a period of time.
2. Reflect on how God used the experience and how you experienced Him. List what you learned in the Life Lessons column.
3. Identify the biblical concept in what He was teaching you. What scriptures are tied to this concept? List the Biblical concept and scripture in their respective columns.

Step 3 - Crystallizing Life Lessons

1. Review the lessons and phrase them to make them easy to remember - alliteration, rhyme, short phrase, etc.
2. Consider if there are Themes - the Lord may reveal some themes in how you have experienced Him and His work in your life. As you become aware of them, add these to your worksheet.
3. Share your life lessons with others to get their feedback.
4. Periodically come back to your timeline and see if God will grant you insight into life lessons from other memorial stones.

MEMORIAL STONES

Step 1: Personal Memorial Stones (Example)

Timeframe	Favorable people, events, etc	Difficult people, events, etc
Freshmen year	Bible study; friendship with *S	Break-up; Halloween partying
Sophomore year	SF trip with *R; study abroad	Roommate conflict; SHAW study
Junior year	sister reading Bible; missions trip	Grandma's death; mental health issues
Senior year	Sister dinners; discipling *L	Relationship with *E; discerning future

Step 2-3: Life Lessons Exercise (Example)

Memorial Stones	Biblical Concept	Life Lesson	Biblical Passage
1| Deciding to do freshmen Bible study	Guidance	You Jesus, have good things planned for me	Ephesians 2:10; Isaiah 30:21
2| Break-up freshmen year	Chosen by You	Necessary to experience better things you had for me	Ephesians 1:4-5
3| Teaching sister how to read the Bible	You pursue people	You invite me to pray for and invest in others	1 Thess 2:8
Theme - God, you are faithful to protect and choose me.			

Reflection & Application

- How does this impact your relationship Jesus? Your ministry to others?
- How will these lessons help you persevere in this next season of life?
- How could you integrate or share these life lessons with others in your life and ministry?

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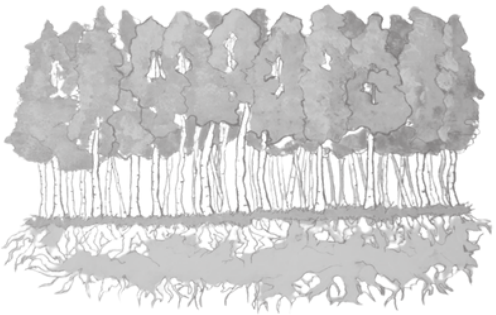

PERSERVERING IN FELLOWSHIP

And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another—and all the more as you see the Day approaching.
Hebrews 10:24-25

Aspen trees are unique in that they have roots that are connected together to unite the trees into one organism. So it is meant to be in the body of Christ -- we are designed to be interconnected to others in the body, united under the headship of Christ. As we journey through life, our primary source of fellowship may shift. In life, we may find belonging in places like friends, our church body, family, and/or marriage. In each of us is the danger towards extremes, either of isolation or co-dependence. Which extreme do you find it easiest to gravitate towards and why?

Spend time considering the verses below that describe how we are to relate to "one another."

- John 13:34-35
- Romans 12:10
- Romans 15:7
- 1 Peter 4:9
- Romans 12:16
- Ephesians 4:32
- Ephesians 4:2-3

We all desire to be fully known and fully loved. To be loved but not known is comforting, but superficial. To be known and not loved is our greatest fear. Consider the quote below by pastor Tim Keller. What stands out to you?

...to be fully known and truly loved is, well, a lot like being loved by God. It is what we need more than anything. It liberates us from pretense, humbles us out of our self-righteousness, and fortifies us for any difficulty life can throw at us

Consider the principles below and what the Bible teaches us about community. What principle impacts you the most?

1. Mankind was not meant to be alone (Gen 2:18)
2. Mankind has always feared isolation (Gen 4:13)
3. Mankind has always pursued community (Gen 11:2)
4. Mankind has always been tempted to replace God with community (Gen 11:4)

Consider the four practical principles below. What application would you like to make moving forward in life as you persevere in fellowship with others?

- Intentionality – quality is not dictated by frequency.
- Consistency – patience & repetition wins hearts.
- Vulnerability – model the depth of relationship you want.
- Consolidating – make the most of existing circumstances around you.

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Alongsiders:
LIFE-TO-LIFE DISCIPLESHIP

Alongsiders are committed to making disciples one conversation and one relationship at a time.

JESUS WAS AN ALONGSIDER

Jesus intentionally ministered Life-to-Life™ with a select few. When the Lord invited His disciples to "be with him" (Mark 3:14), it meant joining the Lord in His life. Together, they went to social events and on walking expeditions. They enjoyed faith conversations, and shared in the joys and sorrows of ministry.

PAUL AS AN ALONGSIDER

The apostle Paul practiced a relational approach to ministry. Even though he often launched a church and moved on, he still maintained a relational ministry. From his example in the Thessalonian church, what can you observe about his relational approach?

Read these sections of 1 Thessalonians:

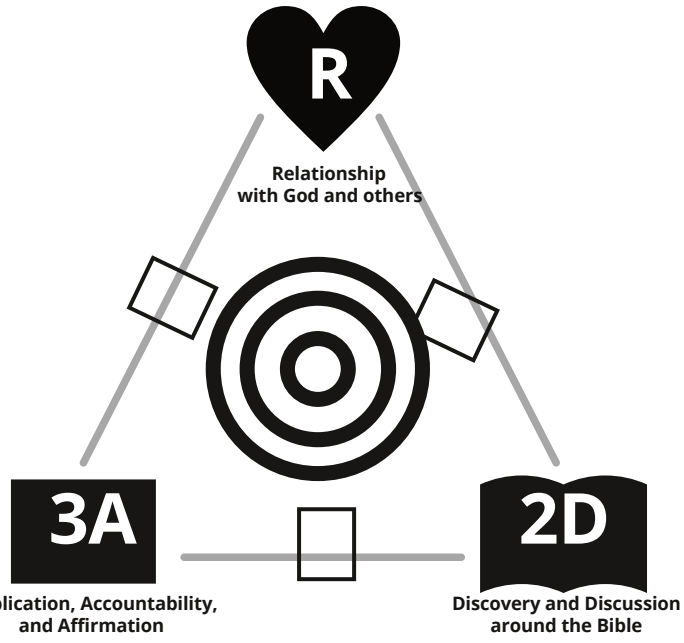
- 1 Thessalonians 2:7
- 1 Thessalonians 2:8
- 1 Thessalonians 2:11-12

- What do you think it meant for Paul to be like a mother or a father to this new group of believers?
- Describe Paul's intentionality in growing the faith of these new believers.

YOU AS AN ALONGSIDER

Who has God placed you alongside in your work, home, or play aspects of life? Is there someone in your spheres of relationship that you can come alongside and disciple?

An overview of how an alongsider structures discipleship.



BULL'S-EYE: The New Testament's portrait of a disciple becomes the target you aim for in making disciples.

R: The R stands for relationships. A relationship with God and a relationship with those whom we disciple provide the appropriate context for the disciplemaking process.

2D: There is always an open Bible between an alongsider and the person he or she is discipling. Around this open Bible, discovery and discussion (2D) take place.

3A: Discipleship includes application, accountability, and affirmation. Alongsiders are on an application journey. Accountable relationships encourage follow-through. Affirmation encourages people to keep going.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/alongsiders
Excerpt from The Ways of the Alongsider: Growing Disciples Life to Life by Bill Mowry, used with permission by Navpress.com

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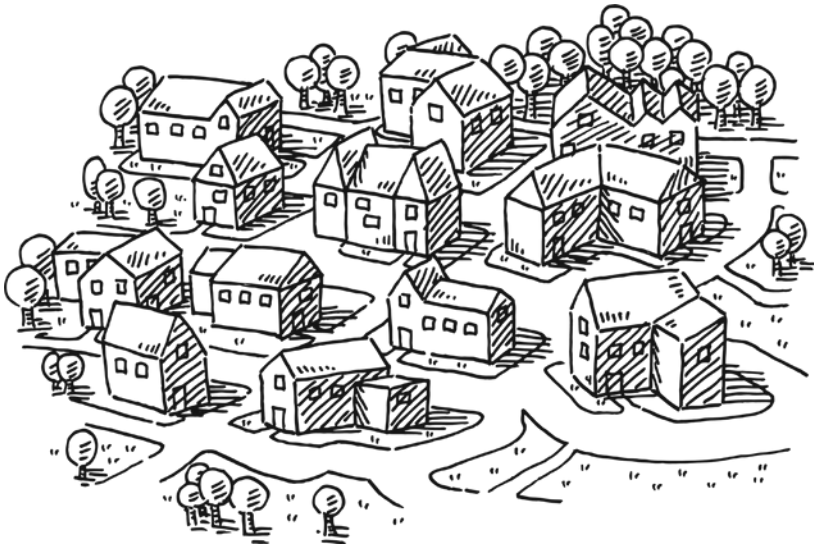

30 DAYS OF PRAYING THROUGH YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD

By: Kirk Lauckner (Navigators 20's, Seattle)

There is something deep and transformational that happens when we walk the streets of our commu- nity while conversing with God.

This is an invitation to au- dacity - to believe that the gospel is transformative today and that God's Spirit is at work in the unique- ness of our own individual- ity and that of our neigh- borhoods.

Throughout the next 30 days, be intentional. Take time to WALK, PRAY, PAY ATTENTION, and LISTEN.

Day One: *Lord, would you please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this place I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighbor- hood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Two: Do I know the names of my neighbors? *Lord, help me to learn the names of those living by me.*

Day Three: *Lord, thank You for the gift of a new day! May You surprise me as I walk these streets and enjoy this time with You. May a "divine appointment" happen today!*

Day Four: When was the last time I was invited to my neighbors' home? When was the last time I had a neighbor over for dinner? *Lord, would You give me the time and capacity to prac- tice hospitality? Is there someone we could invite for dinner within the next month?*

Day Five: *Lord, help me be faithfully present in my neighborhood. May I inten- tionally say "yes" and "no" to the right things so I have more time for my neigh- bors.*

Day Six: What promises am I praying over my neighbor- hood? While I am walking today bring to mind specif- ic scripture that speaks to loving people, the neighborhood, and the expansion of the gospel.

Day Seven: Are there other Christ-followers in my neighborhood? Who else can join us? *Lord, would you please help me identify "people of peace" or people who care deeply about my neighborhood.*

Day Eight: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighbor- hood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Nine: *Lord, help me to see my neighborhood with Your eyes. May my heart break for those things that break Your heart.*

Day Ten: Today while walking I will bring a bag and pick up trash along the way. *Lord, thank you for Your creation; help me to steward and care for the beauty of the earth You have made.*

Day Eleven: Today I will give thanks! As I walk I will focus on the blessings that God has given me. Much like a riv- er that is overflowing, I will al- low "thanks" to well up inside my heart. *Lord, thank You for my neighborhood, my home, food, and the daily comforts that I so often take for grant- ed. Thank You!* "So then, just as you received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to live in Him, rooted and built up in Him, strengthened in the faith as you were taught, and **overflowing with thankful- ness.**" (Colossians 2:6-7)

30 DAYS OF PRAYING THROUGH YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD

Day Twelve: Today as I walk I will pay attention to the buildings, the businesses, non-profits, schools, and churches. What is already happening in my neighbor- hood and how may I join in and help these organizations? *Lord, please lead me as I consider how involved I should become in my neighborhood.*

Day Thirteen: Today I will pray at a park or playground. When was the last time I intentionally visited our community center? *Lord, I long to be a "known character", one that is recognized, loved, and respect- ed. Use me in this "place".*

Day Fourteen: Today I will pray for laborers to flow out of the neighborhood. "When He saw the crowds, He had compassion on them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd. Then He said to His disciples, 'The harvest is plentiful but the workers are few. Ask The Lord of the harvest, therefore, to send out work- ers into His harvest field.' " (Matthew 9:36-38)

Day Fifteen: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Sixteen: Today I will meditate on these four words: **Soften**, **Center**, **Listen**, and **Respond**. *Lord, may you keep my heart* **Soft** *and open,* **Centered** *in Christ,* **Listening** *to your Holy Spirit, and* **Respond-ing** *in love.*

Day Seventeen: Today I will invite a friend to join me as I walk. (The relationship with this person will determine whether we pray together or simply walk while praying silently.) "For where two or three come together in My name, there I am with them." (Matthew 18:20)

Day Eighteen: "The entire law is summed up in a single command: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' " (Galatians 5:14)

Day Nineteen: Who are the neighbors that God is moving and drawing me towards, nudging me to take that next step from "acquaintance" into "relationship"? *Lord, will You help me move towards friendship with my neighbors, going beyond simply knowing their names.*

Day Twenty: "You are the light of the world. A city on a hill cannot be hidden. Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way let your light shine before men, that they may see your good deeds and praise your Father in heaven." (Matthew 5:14-16)

Day Twenty-One: When was the last time we had a party at our house? Who could we invite? Who could help us? "Then Levi held a great banquet for Jesus at his house, and a large crowd of tax collectors and others were eating with them." (Luke 5:29)

Day Twenty-Two: *Lord, thank You for the gift of a new day! May You surprise me as I walk these streets and enjoy this time with You. May a "divine appointment" happen today!*

Day Twenty-Three: *Lord, would you please deepen my love for my neighbor- hood, this place I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Twenty-Four: Today as I walk I will ask God to give me a picture of what our neighborhood could become. *Lord, please increase the vision for my neighborhood.*

Day Twenty-Five: Today as I walk I will pray for insight on how I can "link" with other neighborhoods within my city.

Day Twenty-Six: "The number one obstacle to neighboring well is time. Do you currently live at a pace that allows you to be present in your neighborhood?" (*The Art of Neighboring*)

Day Twenty-Seven: "From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined the times set for them and the exact places where they should live." (Acts 17:26-27)

Day Twenty-Eight: "Remember that God is and has been at work in your neighborhood. Part of leadership is attuning yourself to the breath of God as He brings new life to the dry bones of your place. Live in the freedom that comes from knowing that God loves your neighborhood far more than you ever will. You can actually trust God's love for your place." (*The New Parish*)

Day Twenty-Nine: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Thirty: "I'll be with you as you do this, day after day after day, right up to the end of the age." (Matthew 28:20)

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED.
To download this resource, visit navlink.org/neighborhood

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Empower

SHARE GOD'S LOVE WITH YOUR NEIGHBORS

Jesus puts loving God and neighbor into perspective:

"Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the first and greatest commandment. And the second is like it: Love your neighbor as yourself" (Matthew 22:37-39).

In John 1, we see that Jesus came to us in flesh and blood—God incarnate. Eugene Peterson in The Message paraphrase of the Bible expresses Jesus' coming this way:

The Word became flesh and blood, and moved into the neighborhood. (John 1:14)

God has placed you in your neighborhood for a reason, so consider how you can show God's love to your neighbors.

7 SIMPLE WAYS TO SHOW CHRIST'S LOVE TO YOUR NEIGHBORS:

• **Greet people.** Say hello as you walk along your block or work in your yard.

• **Go out front.** Be intentional about spending time in the more public parts of your yard or building. Rather than sitting on your back patio, put chairs in front of your house.

• **Go first.** Often people are just waiting for someone else to take the initiative. They may be open to connecting but just haven't gotten around to starting the connection. Go first by introducing yourself, sharing information, and asking questions.

• **Gather contact information.** Collect names, phone numbers, and email addresses for those on your block or the floor of your apartment building. Express how you want to help people be connected to each other in times of need. Ask people their permission to share the list on the block.

• **Give and receive.** Be the neighbor who offers to give help to others, whether it's loaning out a tool or a cup of sugar for a neighbor's baking project. Also be willing to receive. Ask for help when you need it, as that can break down barriers.

• **Get creative.** Consider what makes your neighborhood unique and how you can love and serve your neighbors. Your own actions in your neighborhood may be different from what works in another setting.

• **Go before God in prayer for your neighbors.** Pray specific prayers when you know neighbors well enough to know their situations. Observe and pray for those you don't know as well. For example, a house with toys scattered out front is home to a family — even if you don't know them, pray for God's grace on their family relationships.

Empower

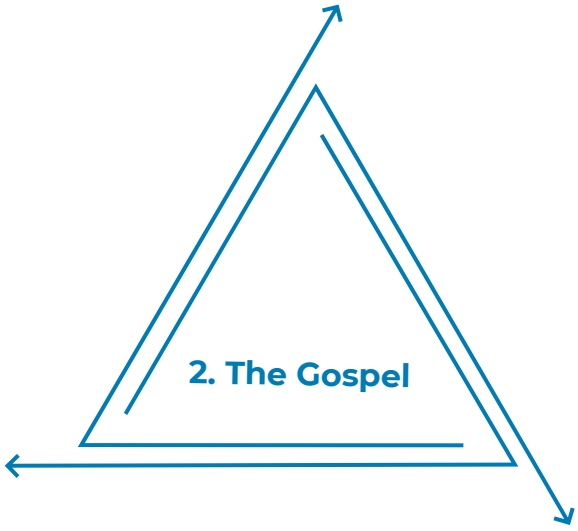
3D GOSPEL

To the weak I became weak, to win the weak. I have become all things to all people so that by all possible means I might save some.
1 Corinthians 9:22

The apostle Paul is emphatic that there is one Gospel. But this same Gospel is good news to all people everywhere! **Begin by watching the video linked below. Then read the different narratives provided. Consider how each narrative challenges or expands your view of the Gospel.**

1.Video:

Guilt - Innocence



Shame - Honor

Fear - Power

3. Application

- As a result of this study, how is the Gospel more applicable in your own life?
- How might you phrase the Gospel more applicably to those around you? Consider your family, friends, neighbors and coworkers.

Empower

God is...

30 DAYS OF PRAYING
the Names and Attributes of God

Though God is infinitely far above our ability to fully understand, through the Scriptures He tells us truths about Himself so that we can know Him, and be drawn to worship Him. Take a description of God and meditate on it for a day.

1 JEHOVAH
The name of the independent, self-complete being—"I AM WHO I AM"—only belongs to Jehovah God. Our proper response to Him is to fall down in fear and awe of the One who possesses all authority. *Exodus 3:13-15*

2 JEHOVAH-M'KADDESH
This name means "the God who sanctifies." A God separate from all that is evil requires that the people who follow Him be cleansed from all evil. *Leviticus 20:7,8*

3 INFINITE
God is beyond measurement—we cannot define Him by size or amount. He has no beginning, no end, and no limits. *Romans 11:33*

4 OMNIPOTENT
God is all-powerful. He spoke all things into being, and all things—every cell, every breath, every thought—are sustained by Him. Nothing is too difficult for Him. *Jeremiah 32:17,18, 26,27*

5 GOOD
God is the embodiment of perfect goodness, and is kind, benevolent, and full of good will toward all creation. *Psalm 119:65-72*

6 LOVE
God's love is so great that He gave His only Son to bring us into fellowship with Him. His love encompasses the world, and embraces each of us personally and intimately. *1 John 4:7-10*

7 JEHOVAH-JIREH
"The God who provides." Just as He provided yesterday, He will provide today and tomorrow. He grants deliverance from sin, the oil of joy for the ashes of sorrow, and eternal citizenship in His Kingdom for all those adopted into His household. *Genesis 22:9-14*

8 JEHOVAH-SHALOM
"The God of peace." We are meant to know the fullness of God's perfect peace, His "shalom." God's peace surpasses understanding and sustains us through difficult times. It's the product of fully being what we were created to be. *Judges 6:16-24*

9 IMMUTABLE
All that God is, He has always been. All that He has been and is, He will ever be. He is ever perfect and unchanging. *Psalm 102:25-28*

10 TRANSCENDENT
God is not simply the highest in an order of beings (this would be to grant Him eminence). He is transcendent—existing beyond and above the created universe. *Psalm 113:4,5*

11 JUST
God is righteous and holy, fair and equitable in all things. We can trust Him to always do what is right. *Psalm 75:1-7*

12 HOLY
God's holiness is not a better version of the best we know. God is utterly and supremely untainted. His holiness stands apart—unique and incomprehensible. *Revelation 4:8-11*

30 DAYS OF PRAYING
the Names and Attributes of God

13 JEHOVAH-ROPHE
"Jehovah heals." God alone provides the remedy for mankind's brokenness through His son, Jesus Christ. The Gospel is the physical, moral, and spiritual remedy for all people. *Exodus 15:22-26*

14 SELF-SUFFICIENT
All things are God's to give, and all that is given is given by Him. He can receive nothing that He has not already given us. *Acts 17:24-28*

15 OMNISCIENT
God is all-knowing. God's knowledge encompasses every possible thing that exists, has ever existed, or will ever exist. Nothing is a mystery to Him. *Psalm 139:1-6*

16 OMNIPRESENT
God is everywhere, in and around everything, close to everyone. "'Do not I fill heaven and earth?' declares the Lord." *Psalm 139:7-12*

17 MERCIFUL
God's merciful compassion is infinite and inexhaustible. Through Christ, He took the judgment that was rightfully ours and placed it on His own shoulders. He waits and works now for all people to turn to Him and to live under His justification. *Deuteronomy 4:29-31*

18 SOVEREIGN
God presides over every event, great or small, and He is in control of our lives. To be sovereign, He must be all-knowing and all-powerful, and by His sovereignty He rules His entire creation. *1 Chronicles 29:11-13*

19 JEHOVAH-NISSI
"God our banner." Under His banner we go from triumph to triumph and say, "Thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ" (1 Corinthians 15:57). *Exodus 17:8-15*

20 WISE
All God's acts are accomplished through His infinite wisdom. He always acts for our good, which is to conform us to Christ. Our good and His glory are inextricably bound together. *Proverbs 3:19,20*

21 FAITHFUL
Out of His faithfulness God honors His covenants and fulfills His promises. Our hope for the future rests upon God's faithfulness. *Psalm 89:1-8*

22 WRATHFUL
Unlike human anger, God's wrath is never capricious, self-indulgent, or irritable. It is the right and necessary reaction to objective moral evil. *Nahum 1:2-8*

23 FULL OF GRACE
Grace is God's good pleasure that moves Him to grant merit where it is undeserved and to forgive debt that cannot be repaid. *Ephesians 1:5-8*

24 OUR COMFORTER
Jesus called the Holy Spirit the "Comforter," and the apostle Paul writes that the Lord is "the God of ll comfort." *2 Corinthians 1:3,4*

25 EL-SHADDAI
"God Almighty," the God who is all-sufficient and all-bountiful, the source of all blessings. *Genesis 49:22-26*

26 FATHER
Jesus taught us to pray, "Our Father" (Matthew 6:9), and the Spirit of God taught us to cry, "Abba, Father," an intimate Aramaic term similar to "Daddy." The Creator of the universe cares for each one of us. *Romans 8:15-17*

27 THE CHURCH'S HEAD
God the Son, Jesus, is the head of the Church. As the head, the part of the body that sees, hears, thinks, and decides, He gives the orders that the rest of the body lives by. *Ephesians 1:22,23*

28 OUR INTERCESSOR
Knowing our temptations, God the Son intercedes for us. He opens the doors for us to boldly ask God the Father for mercy. Thus, God is both the initiation and conclusion of true prayer. *Hebrews 4:14-16*

29 ADONAI
"Master" or "Lord." All God's people ought to acknowledge themselves as His servants, with His right to reign as Lord of our lives. *2 Samuel 7:18-20*

30 ELOHIM
"Strength" or "Power": He is transcendent, mighty and strong. This name displays His supreme power, sovereignty, and faithfulness in His covenant relationship with us. *Genesis 17:7,8*

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/names-of-God

Sources: The Knowledge of the Holy, by A.W. Tozer; Names of God, by Nathan Stone; and God of Glory, by Kenneth Landon.

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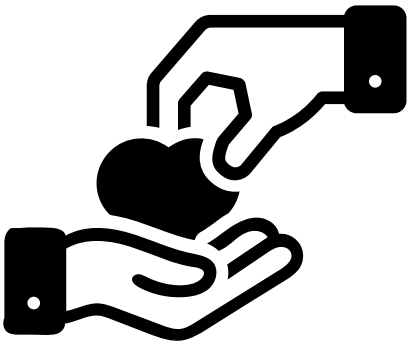

DOING GOOD

Jesus tells us in **Matthew 5:14-16**, *"You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do people light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a stand, and it gives light to all in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven."*

Consider also Paul's words in **Ephesians 2:10,** *"For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them."*

Through doing good to our neighbor and fellow man we display the light of God to a dark and broken world. These good deeds not only give our Father glory, but are prepared beforehand by God for us to do! And while the merit of one's salvation is entirely based on the completed work of Christ's death and resurrection, we are instructed in James 2:14-26 to manifest our faith in Christ through our loving good deeds to those around us.

Spend time doing a Bible Study on the topic of "Doing Good" from the verses and instructions below.

- Psalms 34:14
- Psalms 37:3
- Psalms 37:27
- Ecclesiastes 3:12
- Isaiah 1:17
- Micah 6:8
- Matthew 5:16
- Matthew 7:12
- Matthew 12:12
- Mark 7:37
- Mark 12:30-31
- Luke 6:27
- Luke 6:33-35
- Acts 10:38
- Romans 2:7
- Romans 13:8
- Galatians 5:14
- Galatians 6:9-10
- Ephesians 2:10
- 2 Thessalonians 3:13
- 1 Timothy 6:18
- 2 Timothy 2:21
- 2 Timothy 3:17
- Titus 2:7
- Titus 2:14
- Titus 3:1
- Titus 3:8
- Titus 3:14
- Hebrews 10:24
- Hebrews 13:16
- James 2:8
- 1 Peter 2:12
- 1 Peter 3:8-11

1 Read the included passages seeking to understand the context they were written in.

2 Make observations about "doing good" from the passages included. Consider questions like "what," "who," "where," and "how."

3 Summarize your findings into two or three key statements.

4 Decide on one action you could take in order to apply what you learned from this study. Share that application with a friend.

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THE GREAT TITHING MISUNDERSTANDING

“How much are Christians supposed to give?” A common answer is "10%! Because the 'tithe' is the Lord's! (Deut 14:22)"

So who owns the rest?

Unfortunately an unintended consequence of teaching 10% tithing (giving to a local church) is that many can walk away believing 10% is the Lord's and the rest is ours!

In 2019, Christians gave an average of only 2.5% of their income (during the height of the Great Depression the number was closer to 3.3%). For families making $75k+ income, only 1% give at least 10% in tithing. Americans spend the same amount on missions to the unreached 10-40 window as they do on Halloween costumes... for their pets! Certainly we have some re-learning to do as a culture.

Consider the following two examples and discuss how much you would advise each person to give:

1. A single dad is raising two children. He earns $800/mo, and pays $600 in rent and groceries. How much should the single dad tithe?
2. A wealthy doctor earns $250,000 a year. Tithing 10% leaves this woman with $225,000 a year to live on. How much would you encourage her to give?

Jesus makes mention of the Old Testament tithe in only two passages (Matthew 23:23-24 and Luke 18:9-14). Paul is equally silent on the topic of the 10% tithe. But both Jesus and Paul talk frequently about giving. Read and discuss the two passages listing guidelines from both Paul and Jesus on giving.

- 2 Corinthians 8:7, 9:6-7
- Luke 21:1-4

So how much should a person give? Perhaps a suggestion is to *give in such a way that it makes a difference in your lifestyle*. Biblically, where else might we give? New Testament examples include the poor (Galatians 2:10), orphans and widows (James 1:27), and missions (Philippians 4:10–20). Give where you choose. Paul summed it up in 2 Corinthians 9:7: “*Each man should give what he has decided in his heart to give*.”

Spend time answering the following questions to help form conclusions on this topic: What do you believe about tithing? What are you taught about giving? How do these conclusions influence other areas of your life where you are entrusted something of limited quantity (such as time, energy, etc.)?

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SABBATH

The concept of a weekly day of rest can be very powerful in our lives when exercised in Biblical ways. This brief study merely introduces us to the principle of Sabbath and is meant to encourage us in our lives as we grow in grace, peace, and knowledge of Him.

What is a Sabbath? *"It is a small yet ample chunk of space, a narrow yet full segment of time. In it you can lie down and rest. From it you can rise up and go -- stronger, lighter, ready to work again with vigor and a clear mind. It is room enough, time enough, in which to relinquish all encumbrances, to act as though their existence has nothing whatsoever to do with your own. It is an invitation, at one and the same time, to empty yourself and fill yourself."* The Rest of God, Mark Buchanan.

Spend time studying and making observations from the passages below:

Genesis 2:2-3: *When and why did God introduce the idea of Sabbath?*

Exodus 16:21-30: *The Israelites were just delivered by God from 215 years of slavery. What are some Sabbath concepts in this passage?*

Exodus 19:1-6: *What was the major message God was communicating to Israel?*

Exodus 20:8-11: *Compare the length of the fourth commandment to the other ten. Why do you think that is?*

Exodus 31:12-17: *What important concepts about the Sabbath do you notice? What is God saying the Sabbath is meant to be to the rest of the world?*

Matthew 11:28-30: *What is the message Jesus gives to His disciples? How is this connected to the idea of Sabbath?*

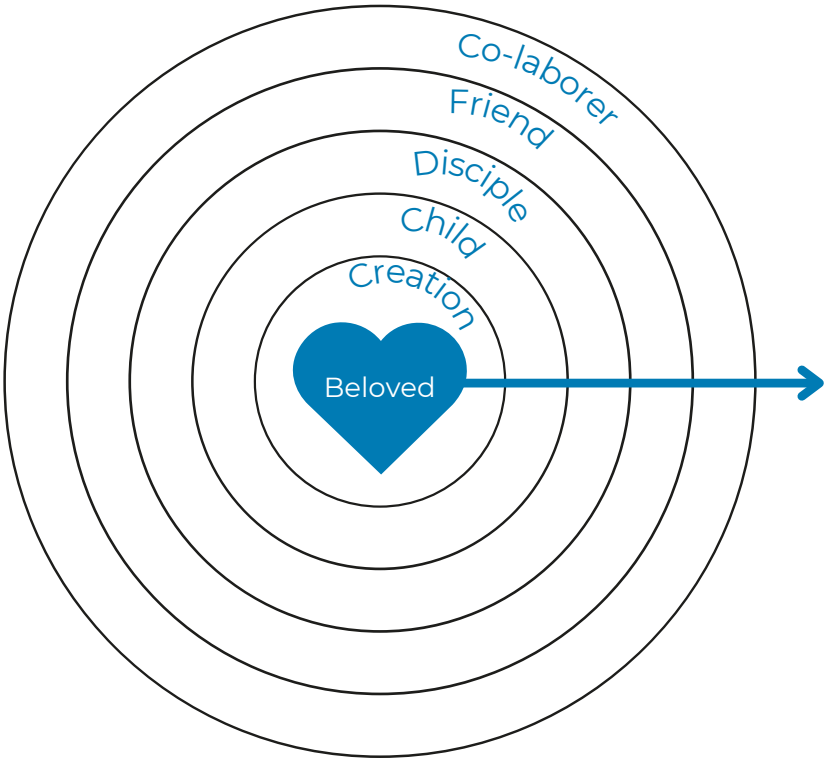
Matthew 12:1-14: *How might Jesus identifying himself as Lord of the Sabbath be significant? How had the Pharisees abused the concept of Sabbath? How is the Sabbath abused today?*

Reflection Questions

- Why do you think God commanded the Israelites to have a Sabbath?
- How is it to be practiced today? What are some practical advantages of a Sabbath?
- What new convictions has God given you? What does God want you to do/not do regarding the Sabbath? What will you apply to your life and ministry as a result of this study?
- What hindrances do you foresee?

Empower

IDENTITY:
BEING BEFORE DOING



There is no hierarchy of identities as followers of God. In fact, because we are in relationship with a trinitarian God, we have multiple relationships with God simultaneously. What is important is not the achievement of new "identity qualifiers" but rather the reality that we are beloved before we do anything for God.

***Beloved*:** Before anything we do and after everything we have done, we are deeply loved by God.
(Jeremiah 31:3, Zephaniah 3:17, John 3:16, Romans 5:8)

***Creation*:** Whether we choose to follow Jesus as our Lord and savior or we remain in rebellion, no one may escape the fact that they are a creation of the mighty and eternal creator God. And if a creation, then a bearer of His image.
(Genesis 1:27, Psalm 139:13-16, Isaiah 45:6)

***Child*:** The very first identifier God gives us as beloved creations is child. This is exclusive to those that put their faith in Jesus, who won on the cross the reconciliation of all people to God, and it requires no effort on our part to receive this title.
(John 1:12, Romans 8:15, 1 John 3:1)

***Disciple*:** As a child of God, he invites us to not only learn from Him but imitate Him and His life. To learn how to live like a son, we have to learn from the Son. As students of a mighty rabbi, we must seek to study His word and heed His instruction.
(Matthew 4:19, John 6:68-69, Galatians 2:20)

***Friend*:** As we follow our mighty creator, father, savior, and teacher, we grow in intimacy with Him as a friend. It is hard to live in friendship with a creator and father who you do not obey first.
(Exodus 33:11, Psalm 25:14, John 15:15)

***Co-laborer*:** Shared Goals are relational glue. It is apparent and significant that God does not need man's help, but desires the relationship of laboring together in the "family business" of making disciples. He chooses us to help accomplish His advancement of His kingdom here on earth.
(1 Corinthians 3:9, Ephesians 2:10, Colossians 1:28-29)

Empower

THE COMMON RULE

We are shaped by the company we keep and the habits we form. That is why it is vital to be intentional about determining our close friends and our cornerstone habits.

The author Justin Whitmel Earley wrote a book called The Common Rule, where he offered a helpful guide for loving God and our neighbors.

Consider the domains below:

LOVE OF GOD

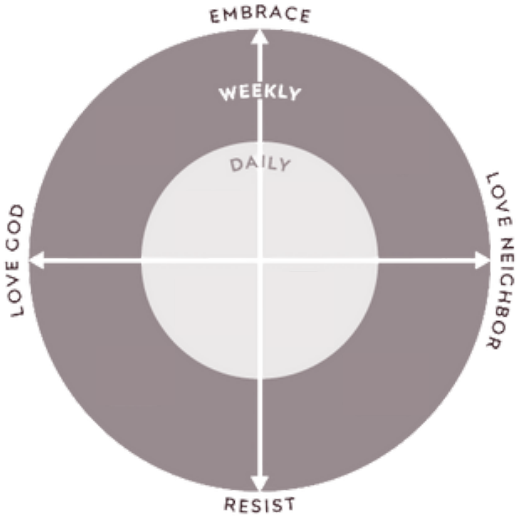
Another way to look at the habits is as they pertain to love of God. You were made to love and be loved by God. Only in light of this love will you see who you really are and discover what to do with your days.

LOVE OF NEIGHBOR

When we think of better habits, we often think about our own self-improvement. In the Common Rule, these habits are meant to be practices with others for their sake.

EMBRACE

Embrace is a reminder that there is much good in the world God made. We want to be intentional to take advantage of it through regular rhythms.



RESIST

When we practice resistance, we acknowledge that evil and suffering are very real, and not how the world was meant to be. The purpose of resistance is to love; not shield you from the world, but turn your compassion towards it.

Now spend time creating a Common Rule for yourself to more intentionally love God and others in this season. Share this with some friends and determine how you would like to hold each other accountable.

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THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. Adapted from The Common Rule by Justin Whitmel Earley.

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